FirstPass STUDIO

USER GUIDE

Version 1 · October 2026 · by PIVT

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

Graphics for the stream, from the first whistle to the last.

FirstPass Studio draws broadcast graphics for a netball livestream, fed straight from PlayHQ and sent to your switcher. This guide starts with the way most nights run, one operator and Studio doing the rest, then covers running it by hand, setting up a competition, sponsors, athletes and the Stream Deck.

Screenshots use the fictional Elite Netball League.



CHAPTER 1 OF 11

What Studio is

FirstPass Studio is a Mac app that draws broadcast graphics for a netball livestream and sends them to your vision switcher. The scores, clocks, ladders, fixtures and line-ups come from PlayHQ's public data, so there is nothing to type in during the game.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 The words used in this guide
2 The pages you work in
3 The sample competition in this guide

Studio does one job on stream night: graphics. Your cameras, switcher and streaming encoder stay as they are. Studio hands the switcher a picture with transparency (fill and key, or a chroma colour) so the graphics sit over the vision.

The words used in this guide

Studio
The whole thing: the Mac app, the pages you work in, and the graphics it puts on screen.

On air, off air
Studio is on air while a Studio window is open. On air it talks to PlayHQ, serves the graphics and answers the Stream Deck. Closing the last window takes it off air.

A graphic, or a page
One thing that can go on screen: the scoreboard, a ladder, a lower third, an animation. Each is a web page that Studio draws.

A source
A graphic placed in the scene, with its own position, options and fade. The scoreboard is one source; a ladder is another.

The scene
Studio's own 1920 × 1080 frame, built from sources switched on and off. It is what the switcher receives.

A scene (on the Scenes list)
A saved look: which sources are on and which are off. "Live game" and "Clear" are scenes.

A sequence
A list of steps played in order from one press: a run-up, a quarter-time break, a full-time wrap.

The competition
Everything that belongs to one league: its PlayHQ link, names, rules, colours, logos, sponsors and athletes. Studio keeps a setup per competition and uses one at a time.

The data folder
Where Studio saves everything, outside the app, so updates never touch it.

The pages you work in

Every Studio window has the same tab bar: **Output**, **Production Planner**, **Scoreboard control**, **Competitions setup**, **Sponsors**, **Athletes**, **Stream Deck**, **Socials** and **Docs** (⌘1 to ⌘9 in the app). Output is where the show is built and sent out; the Production Planner plans the court and the commentators for each night; Scoreboard control runs the board; Socials makes the night's pictures for social media; the rest are set up before the night.

The sample competition in this guide

The screenshots use a fictional league, the **Elite Netball League**, with eight clubs named after animals (Falcons, Panthers, Stingrays, Cobras, Grizzlies, Hawks, Rhinos and Wolves) across Premier, Men's and Under 21 divisions, playing at the Metro Arena. Its sponsors are fictional too. Everything you see is what Studio draws for any competition once its setup is in.

CHAPTER 2 OF 11

Getting started

Install the app, import or make your competition, and learn the one rule that matters on stream night: keep a Studio window open.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Install
2 On air and off air
3 The 1P menu
4 Before you go on air

Install

1. Download `FirstPass Studio.dmg`, drag the app to Applications and open it. It runs on Apple silicon Macs (M1 and later).
2. The **1P** icon appears in the menu bar, off air. Choose **Open Studio**. A short splash shows, Studio goes on air and the Output page opens in the app's own window.
3. Go to **Competitions setup** and either **Import a template file** (your league's `.json`, with its logos and sponsors inside) or **New competition** and fill it in (Chapter 6).
4. Back on **Output**, add the graphics you need with **Add page**, and turn on the video output that feeds your switcher (Chapter 3).

On air and off air

Studio only runs while a Studio window is open. Opening one (Open Studio, any page in the 1P menu, or ⌘N) puts it on air; closing the last one takes it off air, and the graphics and Stream Deck get no answer until a window opens again. Closing the last window while on air asks first, and so does ⌘Q, so a stray keypress can't stop a stream. Leave the Output page open all night.

The status line under the Output page's title shows the game on the board, whether scores and clock follow PlayHQ, how long since PlayHQ last answered (amber when overdue, red after a minute of errors) and whether the video output is on. If anything is wrong, this line says so on the page you keep open.

The 1P menu

Open Studio, Scoreboard control, Competition setup, Copy the Studio link, Devices..., Install the Stream Deck plugin, Back up... and Restore..., Settings folder (iCloud Drive),

Open the settings folder, Open the debug log, Open the app log, Restart Studio, Open at login, Only this Mac can change things, What's new..., Check for updates, Stop Studio (while on air) and Quit. Updates download in the background and install when the app quits, never mid-stream; **Restart to update** installs one straight away.

LINKS

Studio's links start with the Mac's Bonjour name, such as `http://matts-macbook-pro.local:8080/` , so the same link works from a phone, another computer or a Stream Deck on the same network. `http://localhost:8080` works on the Mac itself.

Before you go on air

1. **Open the app.** The Output page opens and Studio goes on air. Keep a window open all night.
2. **Right competition.** Competitions setup shows the one in use at the top. Check its PlayHQ link, the court to follow and the scoring window.
3. **Right game.** On Scoreboard control, the picked game is tonight's first on your court and Follow PlayHQ is on.
4. **Scores arrive.** Once the scorer has started on PlayHQ, the control page says the game is being live scored and the board moves. Nothing is read before the scoring window opens, so a quiet board before then is normal.
5. **Scene and output.** On Output, turn on the display, NDI or Blackmagic output your switcher takes, check fill and key or chroma, and show one graphic to see it land.
6. **Sound.** Play a few seconds of music and an animation with sound, and check the sound only comes out where you want it.
7. **Stream Deck.** Press a Source key and watch the Sources list follow it. A score key switches scoring to Manual, so put it back to Follow PlayHQ after testing.
8. **Sponsors.** Tonight's spots and ads are on; the sponsor report starts counting when the output turns on.

CHAPTER 3 OF 11

Game night, the automated way

This is how most nights run: one operator, PlayHQ scoring the game, a base scene that stays on, automatic layers that fire by themselves, and sequences that handle the run-up, the breaks and full time.

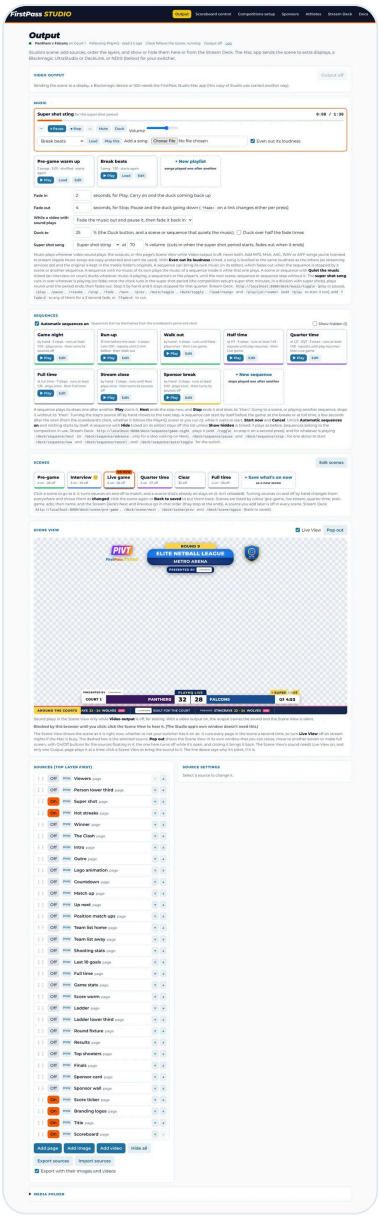
IN THIS CHAPTER

1 How it fits together
2 Scoreboard control
3 The Output page
4 The base scene
5 Automatic layers
6 Scenes
7 Sequences
8 Music, playlists and mics
9 Video output
10 A night, start to finish
11 The Production Planner
12 Socials

How it fits together

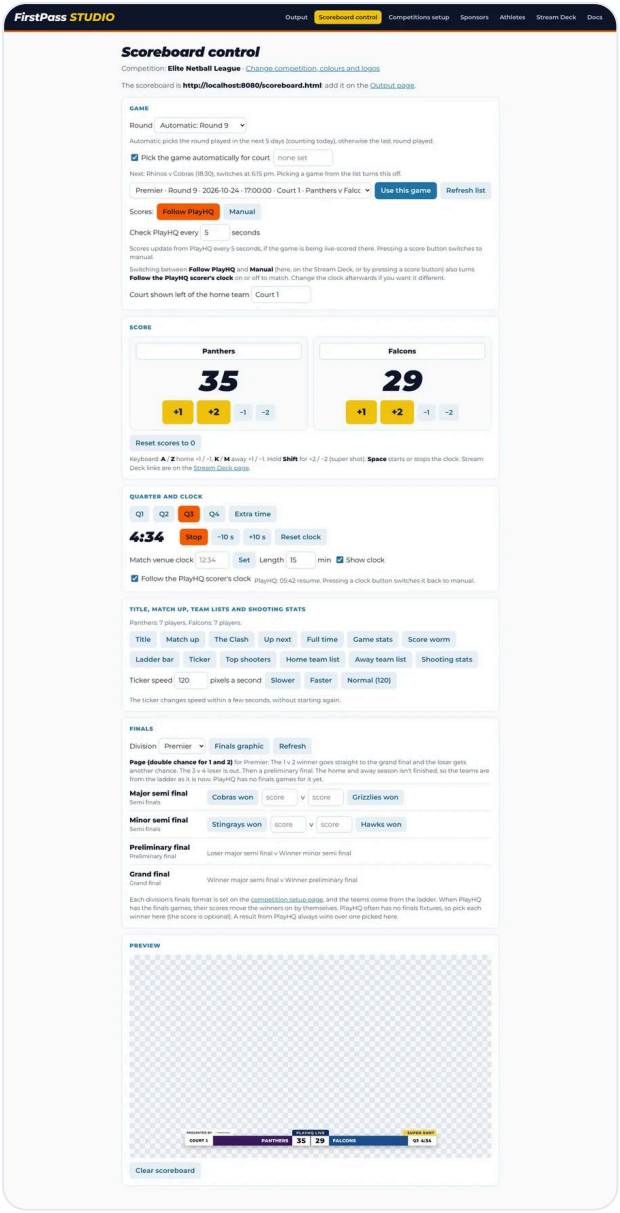
Four things do the work, and each one is set up once:

- **Follow PlayHQ.** The scoreboard reads the live score, quarter and clock from the same feed the PlayHQ game page uses, every 5 seconds by default (as often as every second), while someone live-scores the game on PlayHQ. Automatic game selection moves the board to each next game on your court as its electronic scoring starts.
- **The base scene.** A saved scene with the sources that stay on through the game: the scoreboard, the title banner, the branding logos and the score ticker.
- **Automatic layers.** Sources that stay on but only show when something happens: the super shot celebration, the hot streaks and game moments, the super shot tab on the scoreboard, the naming-rights sponsor's tab. They watch the board and play by themselves.
- **Sequences.** Steps played in order for the parts of the night that aren't live play: the run-up, the walk out, quarter and half time, full time and the close. A sequence can start by itself from the game's clock, carry music, and hand over to another sequence.



The Output page is the whole show on one page: video output, music, sequences, scenes, the Scene View, and the sources with their settings.

- **Scoreboard control**



Scoreboard control: the game, the scoring mode, the score, the quarter and clock, quick links to the game graphics, finals winners, and a preview of the board.

ALWAYS A GAME ON

When Studio starts, it puts a game on the board with Follow PlayHQ on: the game on now on your court, otherwise the first game of tonight on that court. Games are picked by game night, not by round: the list holds every division's games that date, whatever round each is up to, so one division on Round 10 and another on Finals Round 1 sit side by side, each game showing its own round. Tonight is found by date (the first game night in the next 5 days, counting today), so a Tuesday night is found from the Friday before. You can pick another night from the **Game night** list, which names each night's rounds; its games on your court are then followed by their time (the one due now, otherwise the next to come). Set it back to Automatic afterwards.

AUTOMATIC GAME SELECTION

With **Pick the game automatically for court** ticked, the board shows the first game of the night on that court, then switches to each next game when its electronic scoring starts (**Electronic scoring starts N minutes before the game** on the setup page, 10 by default, 15 in the sample league), with the quarter back to Q1 and a full clock. In finals it keeps the final on until PlayHQ marks it finished, in case of extra time. Picking a game from the list by hand turns automatic selection off; tick it again to go back. When the Production Planner has a court for tonight, that court is set here when the night arrives, with **from the Production Planner** beside it. Changing it by hand still works, and the Planner flags it.

FOLLOW PLAYHQ

With **Follow PlayHQ** on, the score and quarter update every 5 seconds from PlayHQ's live scoring, and **Follow the PlayHQ scorer's clock** runs the clock from the scorer's clock. The clock matches the scores: switching to Manual, or pressing any score button, turns clock-following off as well, and the control page says so. Press a clock button to run the clock by hand while scores still follow PlayHQ. To line the clock up with the venue, type the venue's time in **Match venue clock**.

NOTHING BEFORE THE WINDOW

Studio doesn't ask PlayHQ's live feed for a game until its electronic scoring window opens, whether the game was picked automatically or by hand. The control page says when it will start checking.

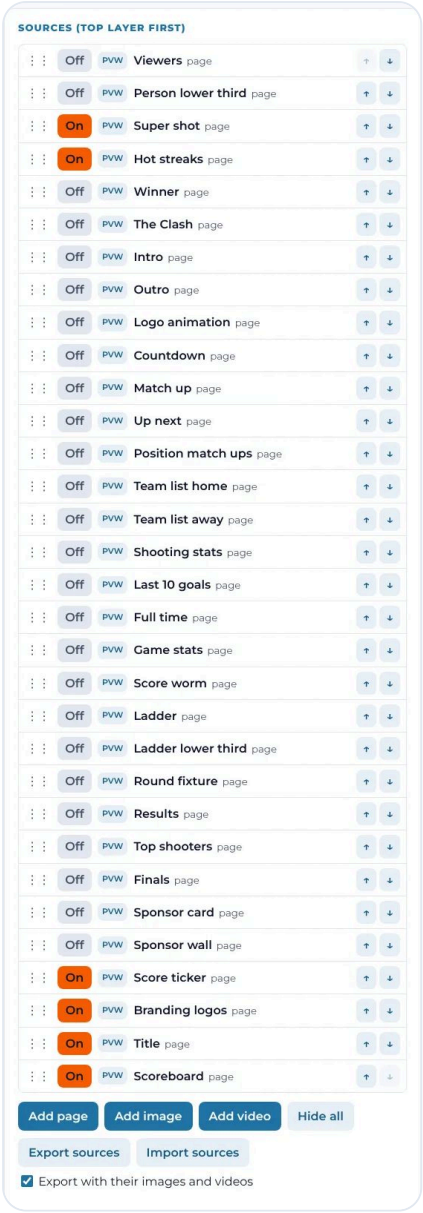
The Output page

The Output page builds Studio's own scene: sources drawn as layers on one 1920 × 1080 frame, top layer first, and sends it to a display, a Blackmagic device or NDI for your switcher.

Every section folds away with the arrow beside its title (or a click on the title), so the ones you don't use, say Music or Switcher, take one line. Studio remembers which are folded on that Mac, even after it restarts, and buttons in a folded section's title row, like **Output on**, still work. The longer explanations on the page wait behind **Expand for info**.

SOURCES

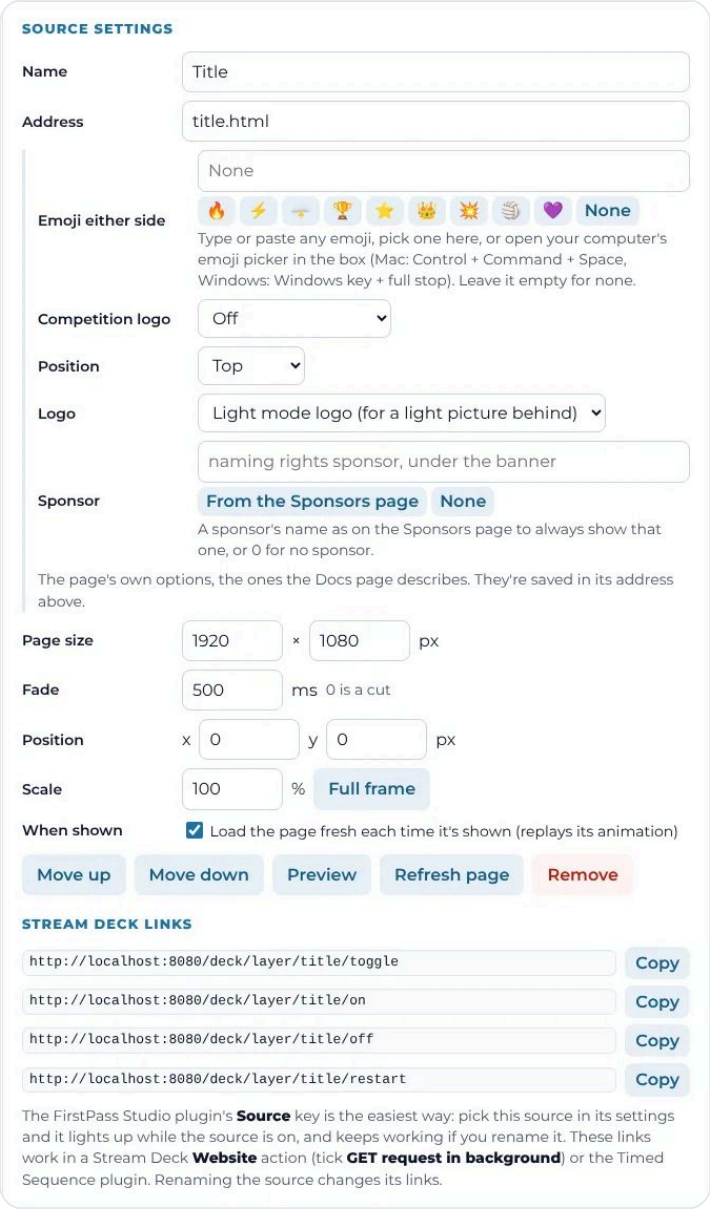
Add page adds any Studio graphic (or any web address), **Add image** a PNG, JPG, GIF, WebP or SVG, and **Add video** an MP4, WebM or MOV. A new source goes in hidden and selected, so its settings are ready to change. Drag a source up or down the list to move it between layers. **Add all unused pages** puts every Studio graphic in the scene at once, hidden.



The Sources list, top layer first. The orange On buttons are the base scene and the automatic layers; everything else waits for a scene, a sequence or a key.

SOURCE SETTINGS

Select a source to change it. A graphic's link options (position, heading, division, round, animate away and so on) show as fields under its address, so there is nothing to look up. **On / Off** fades it in or out over its own **Fade** time (0 is a cut). **Position and scale** place it on the frame. **Load the page fresh each time it's shown** (on by default) reloads a page as it fades in so its animation replays; untick it to keep a page running so it shows instantly. **Preview** (and the small PVW button) opens the source on its own, half size, on a checkerboard.



Source settings for the title banner: its options are fields, and the Stream Deck links for this source are copied from here.

Videos play from the beginning each time they're shown, can loop, and fade out when they finish unless looping; a video that fades out switches its source off, so its key goes dark and the next On plays it again. A ProRes 4444 `.mov` is converted to a transparent WebM when it is added, keeping its alpha. **Export sources** saves the whole scene with its media as one zip to keep or move to another Mac; **Import sources** puts one back.

The base scene

The base scene is what viewers see for most of the game. In the sample league it is the **Live game** scene: the scoreboard at the bottom, the title banner at the top with the PIVT and FirstPass Studio logos on the left and the competition logo on the right, and the score ticker along the bottom edge with the other courts' scores.



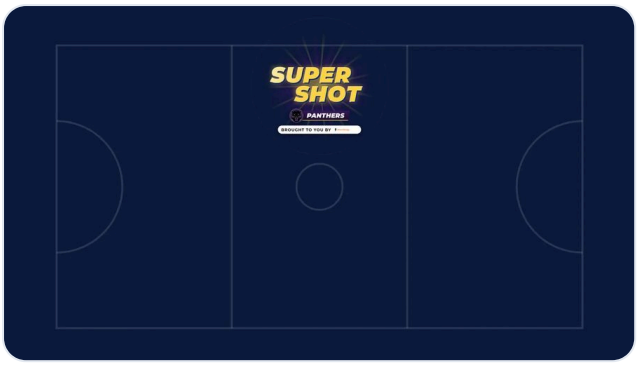
The Live game scene. The court behind it stands in for your vision; the switcher keys the graphics over the cameras.

- **Scoreboard.** Court in a pink box on the left, both teams in their club colours, the score at screen centre, quarter and clock on the right. "PlayHQ live" shows while scores follow PlayHQ; a "Presented by" tab carries the naming-rights sponsor.
- **Title.** Round, competition and venue, with the naming-rights sponsor's pill under it.
- **Branding logos.** PIVT and FirstPass Studio left of the title, the competition logo right of it, so other graphics can be turned on and off around them.
- **Score ticker.** Scrolling scores from tonight's other games, led by a Partner-and-up sponsor's tagline. Its speed is set on the control page or from the Stream Deck.

Build it once: turn those sources on, then press **Save what's on now** under Scenes and name it. From then on, one click (or one Stream Deck key) brings the show back to this look.

Automatic layers

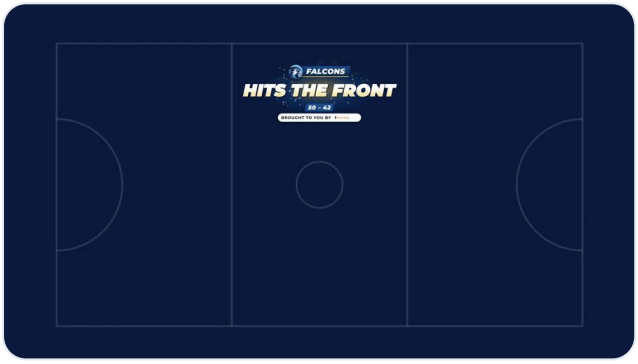
These sources are left on in the base scene and play by themselves from the scoreboard. They add no PlayHQ requests of their own; they ask Studio, which already has the score.



Super shot. A 3-second burst with the team's logo and name in their club colour, played for each successful super shot, from PlayHQ's super shot count or a +2 press. It plays small, centred just under the title.



Hot streaks. "Heating up" at 3 goals in a row, "On fire" at 5, "Goal for goal" when 10 in a row go one each way, from the goal order Studio works out from the score.



Game moments on the same page: hits the front, all square (level in the last 2 minutes), coming back, on the siren, back to back super shots. One goal plays one moment at most.

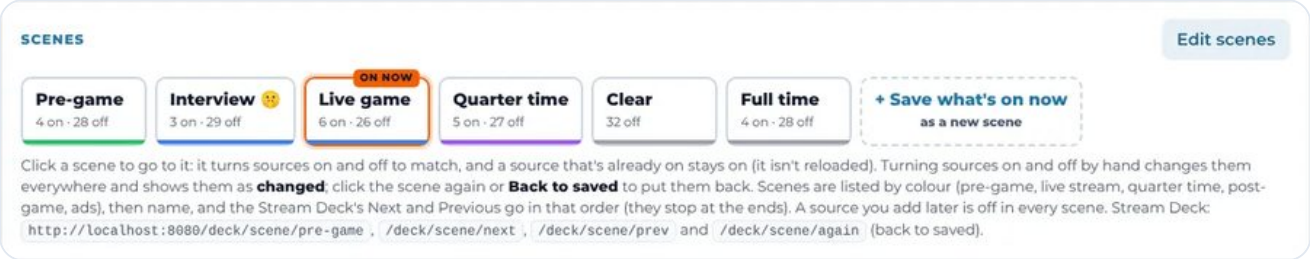


Super shot tab. In a super shot division, a yellow tab rises above the clock for the last minutes of each quarter (set per competition) and sinks away at the siren.

Each celebration can carry a sponsor's "Brought to you by" tag (Chapter 7). A division without super shots plays no super shot animation and counts no super goals; that is set on the competition setup page, per division if needed.

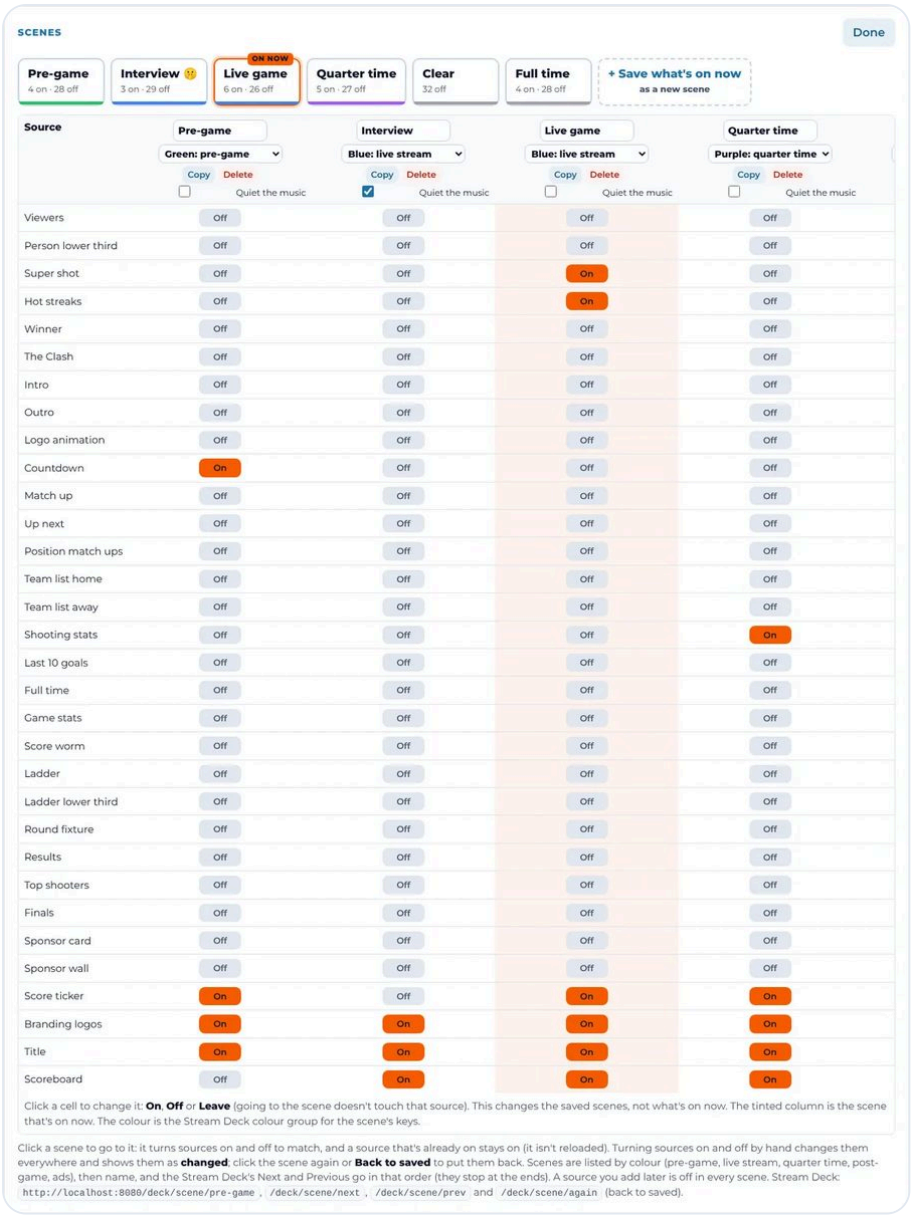
Scenes

A scene is a saved set of sources on and off. Clicking a scene goes to it, turning sources on and off to match while anything already on stays on, not reloaded. Scenes are listed by colour in the order of a stream: green pre-game, blue live, purple quarter time, grey post-game, yellow ads.



The sample league's scenes. Pre-game, Live game, Quarter time, Full time, a quiet Interview scene for an on-court chat, and Clear.

Turn a source on or off by hand after going to a scene and the scene is marked **changed**; the bar under the scenes offers **Back to saved**, **Save over** it, or **Save as new scene**. **Edit scenes** shows a grid, sources down and scenes across, to set each one On, Off or Leave, rename, colour, copy or delete scenes without changing what's on. A source added later is off in every scene.



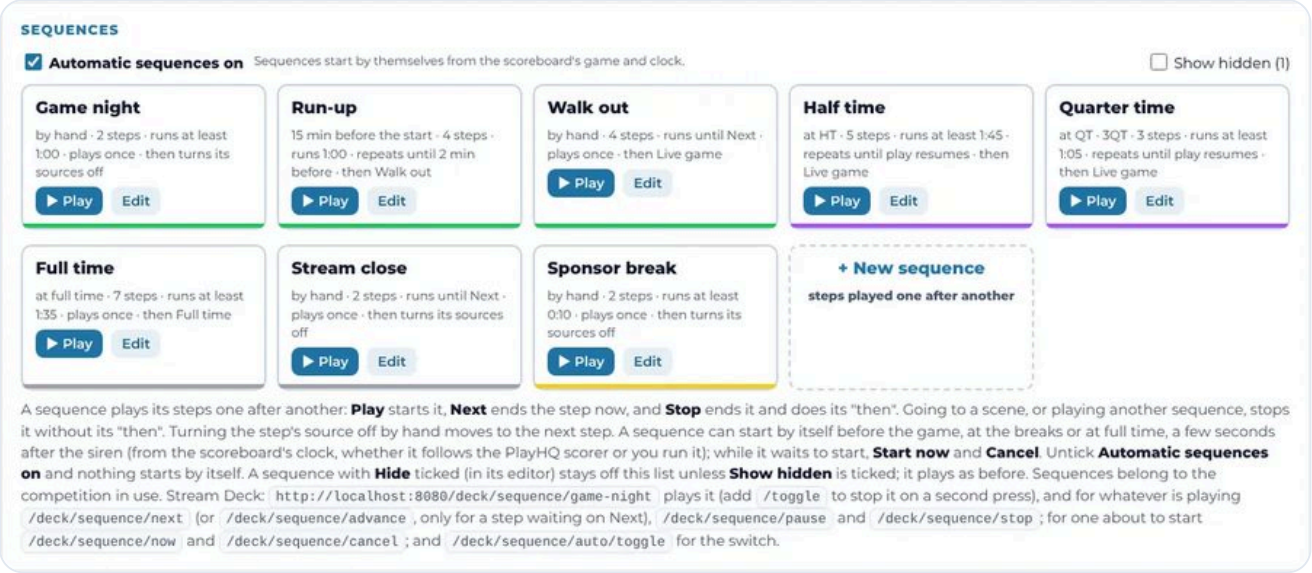
Edit scenes: every source against every scene. "Leave" keeps a source as it is, so a lower third can stay up through a scene change.

QUIET SCENES

Tick **Quiet the music when this starts** on a scene for an interview on court: whatever music is playing ducks and keeps playing until the next scene or sequence without the tick.

Sequences

A sequence plays the scene's sources one after another. Each step turns on the sources you pick and stays for a set time, until it finishes (its videos end or its animation animates away), until the game moves on (the clock starts, or the next break or full time), or until you press Next. As a step ends, sources the next step doesn't use go off with their own fades.

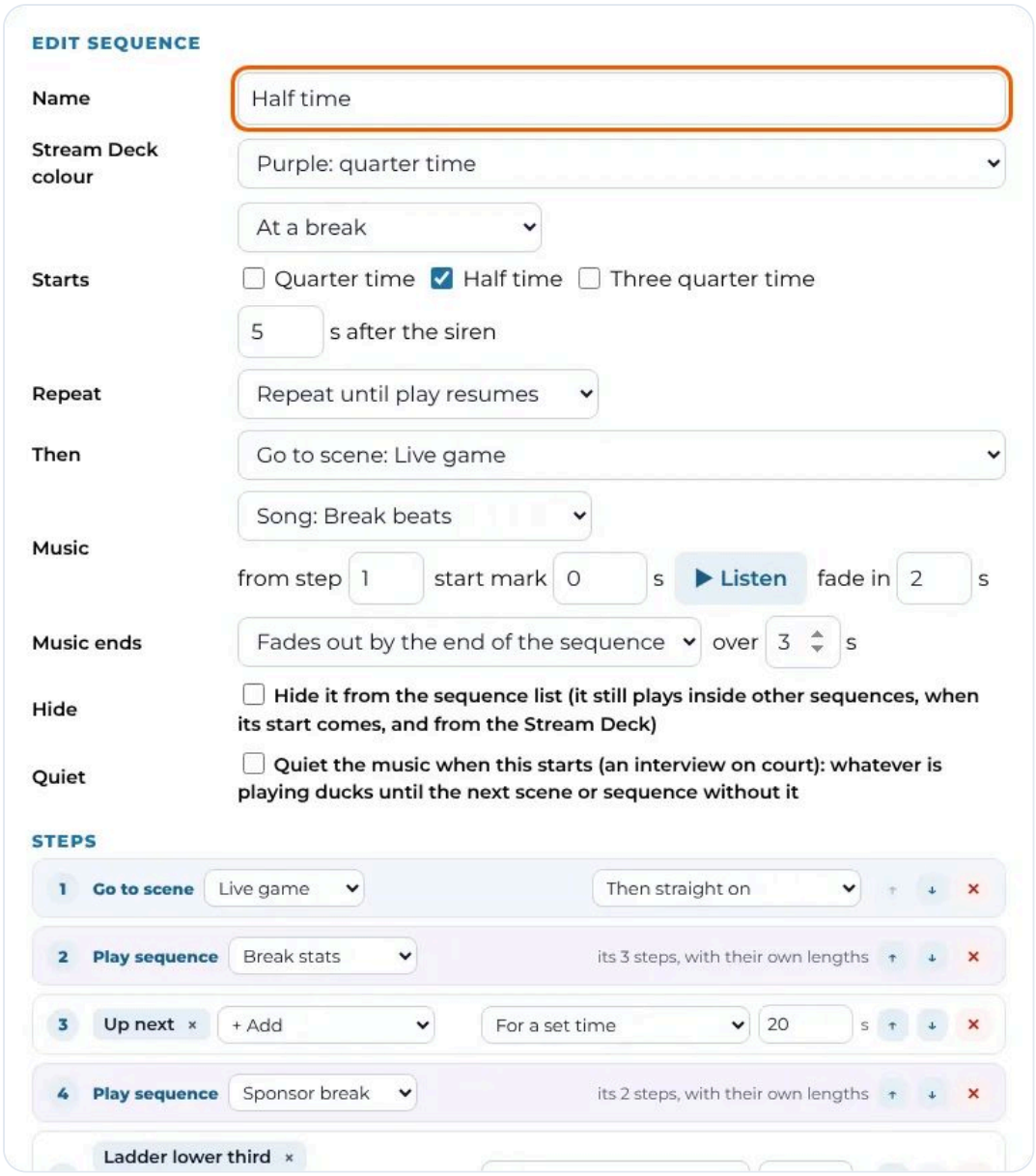


The sample league's sequences. Each card says when it starts, how many steps it has, how long it runs, whether it repeats, and what it does when it ends.

THREE KINDS OF STEP

- **Sources** (**+ Add sources**): one or more sources on together, for a length.
- **A scene** (**+ Add scene**): a starting point or a reset point. What the scene turns on stays on under the next steps and after the sequence. Start a break sequence with the Live game scene and the scoreboard stays up under the stats.
- **Another sequence** (**+ Add sequence**): its steps play in place. Build a mini sequence once (the sample league's **Break stats** and **Sponsor break**) and use it inside Quarter time, Half time and Full time. A sequence made only of sequences is marked **Master**. Tick **Hide** on a mini sequence to keep it off the list; it still plays inside the others and from the Stream Deck.

+ Add sponsor ads adds a step that plays the next one to five sponsor ads in rotation (Chapter 7).

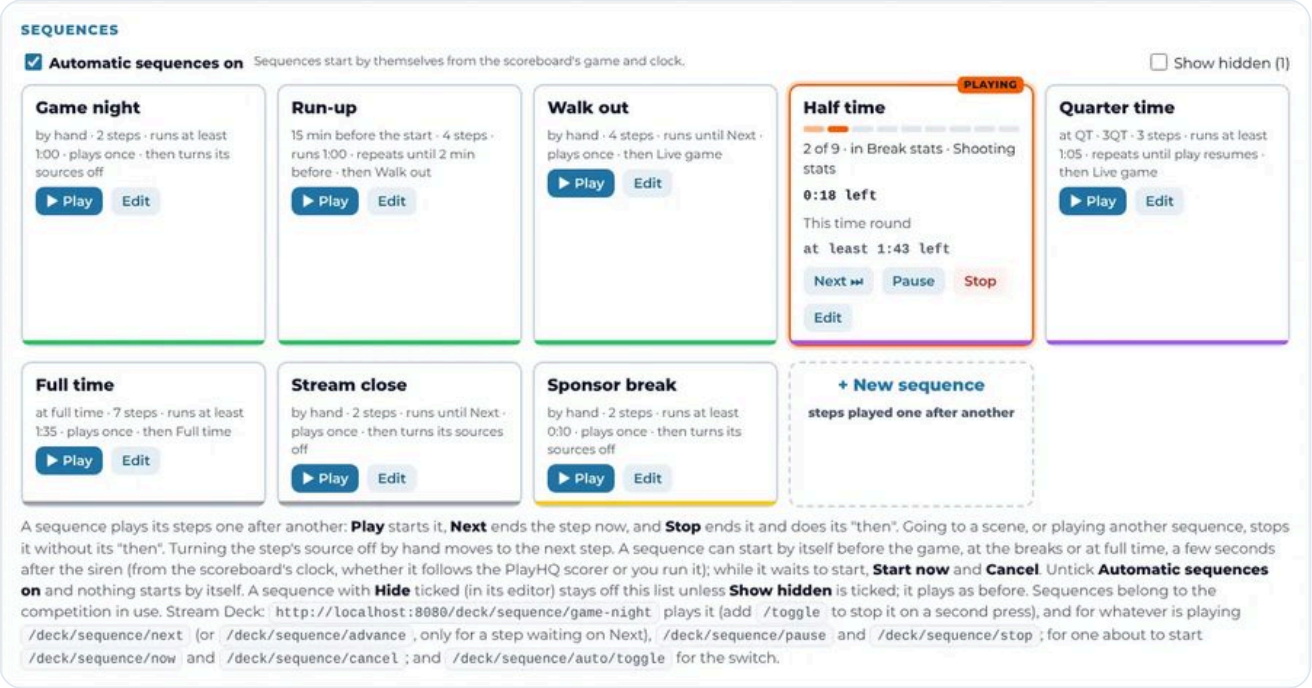


The Half time sequence: starts by itself at half time, repeats until play resumes, plays Break beats, and goes back to the Live game scene when it ends. Its steps are a scene step, two mini sequences and two source steps.

WHEN A SEQUENCE STARTS, REPEATS AND ENDS

SETTING	CHOICES	USED FOR
Starts	By hand · N minutes before the picked game's start (only if Studio was running then; opened later, play it by hand) · at the breaks you tick (QT, HT, 3QT) · at full time, a few seconds after the siren	Run-up 15 minutes out; the breaks and full time from the scoreboard's clock (the PlayHQ scorer's or yours).
Repeat	Play once · until stopped · until play resumes · until N minutes before the start	A break sequence loops until the clock starts again, finishing the step on screen.
Then	Go to a scene · turn off what it turned on · leave everything · play another sequence (one for each output it plays on)	Breaks go back to Live game; Run-up hands over to Walk out.
Music	None · a song or playlist from a step, from a start mark, with a fade in; ends by fading, cutting or carrying on into the next sequence	Warm-up music through the run-up that carries into the walk out.

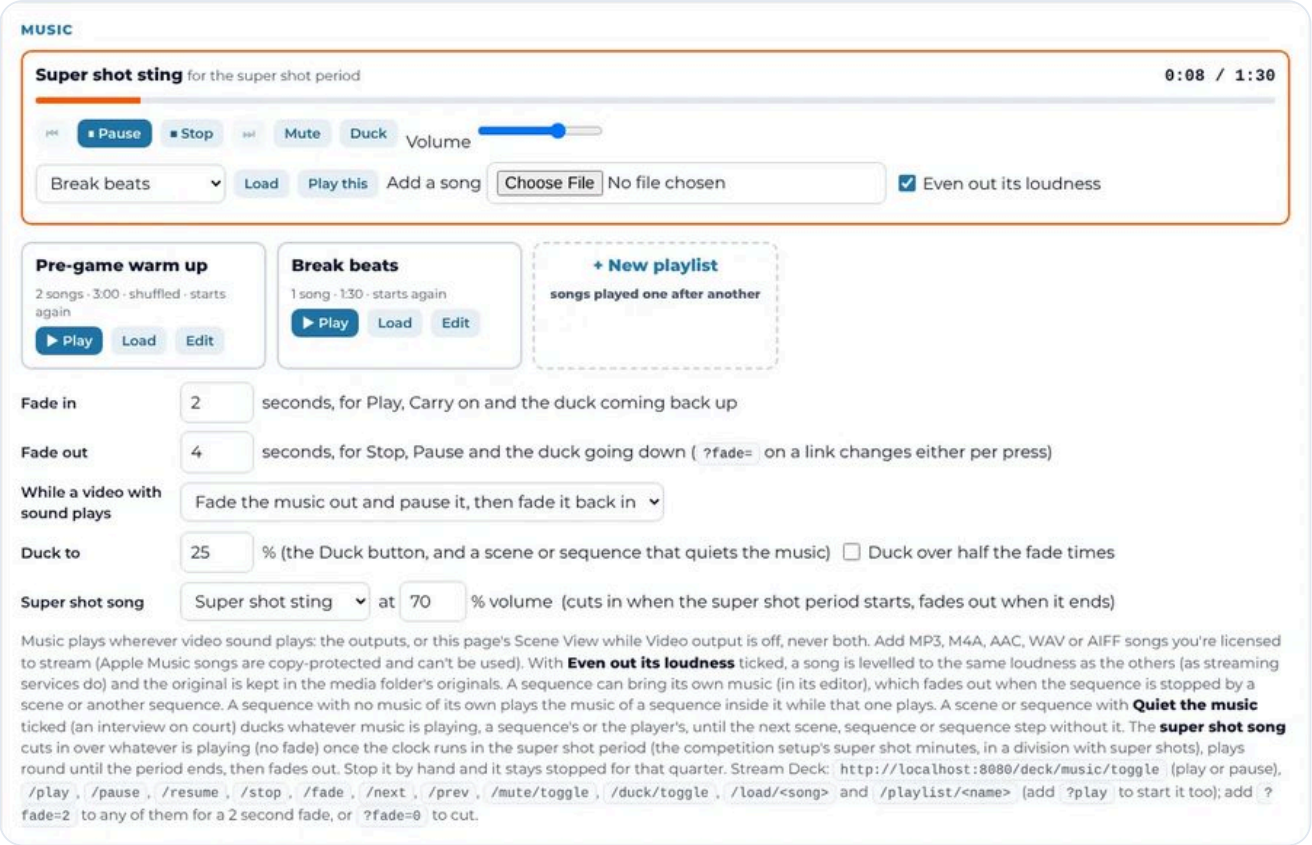
A sequence that starts by itself waits a few seconds as **Starting**, with **Start now** and **Cancel**: press **Cancel** to hold the break back for a shot after the siren and start it by hand when the ball is dead, or **Stop** (or a scene) to come back from a break early. **Automatic sequences on** above the cards is the one switch for all of that, and it is remembered. Only one sequence plays at a time on each output; going to a scene, playing another sequence or hiding everything stops it without its Then. A sequence only ever turns off sources it turned on itself.



While a sequence plays its card shows a dot per step, the time left on the step and for the whole sequence, with Next, Pause and Stop.

Sequences belong to the competition in use and change with **Use this one**; the sources and scenes are shared. The break lengths on the setup page (quarter time, half time, three quarter time) let the editor say how many times a break sequence fits in each break.

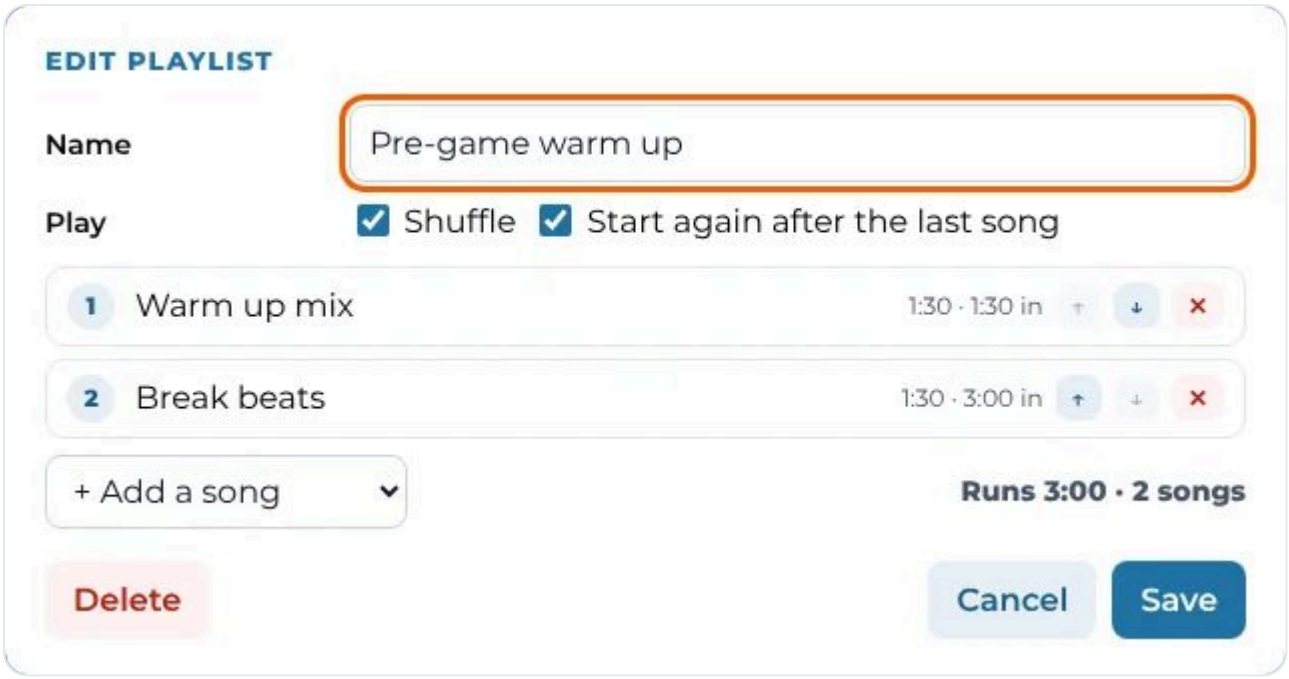
- **Music, playlists and mics**



The Music player, two playlists, and the settings for fades, ducking and what happens under a video with sound.

The Music player plays songs from the media folder (MP3, M4A, AAC, WAV or AIFF; use music you're licensed to stream), one song or a playlist, shuffled or not. Add a song with **Even out its loudness** ticked and it is levelled to match the others. Music plays wherever the video sound plays: through the output, or in the Scene View while Video output is off, never twice.

- **Play** fades in; **Pause** and **Stop** fade out (slower by default). **Duck** dips it low and keeps it running; **Mute** keeps it running silently.
- While a video with its sound on plays, the music fades out and pauses, then fades back in from where it was (or lowers, or carries on: a setting). A themed intro or outro does the same.
- A sequence can bring its own music, and a sequence inside it plays its own while it runs. Going to a scene fades a sequence's music out.
- The **super shot song** cuts in when the super shot period starts in a super shot division, loops, and fades out when the period ends.



A playlist: songs in order, shuffle, and whether it starts again after the last.

Mics. Wireless effects mics on court and crowd mics go out with the music: plug their receivers into the Mac (directly or through an audio interface) and add each one under **Mics**, with its input and channel (two receivers on one stereo input are two mics, left and right). Studio mixes them into Output 1's sound while it's on, never into the Scene View, so a speaker near a mic can't feed back. The first time, the Mac asks whether FirstPass Studio may use the microphone.

- A mic can be plugged into the switcher instead (an ATEM Mini's Mic 1 or Mic 2): the switcher mixes it and Studio moves its fader for the same level, mutes and dips. Move the fader on the switcher and that becomes the mic's level; Studio never moves it back.
- Each mic has a level, a mute, a **Low cut** for wind and rumble and a meter; **Level** and **Mute all** cover every mic, and a limiter stops a shout clipping the stream.
- The mics **dip** while music plays, while a video with its sound plays and during a scene that quiets the music (each a tick box), and by hand with **Dip**. A mic marked **Has an external mixer** never dips: the mixer does the fading.
- Stream Deck: `/deck/mics/mute/toggle`, `/deck/mics/dip/toggle`, `/deck/mics/up`, `/deck/mics/down`, and one mic with `/deck/mic/court-mic/mute/toggle`.

Video output

The **Video output** section at the top of the Output page sends the scene to your switcher. Pick one of three routes, then press **Output on**. While the output is on its settings are locked; turn it off to change them. `/deck/output/on`, `off` and `toggle` do the same from a Stream Deck, and the outputs go dark when Studio goes off air.

ROUTE	WHAT IT NEEDS	WHAT THE SWITCHER GETS
Display	One or two extra displays on the Mac (HDMI into the switcher), set to exactly 1920 × 1080, not HiDPI or scaled	**Chroma**: the scene over a solid colour on one display (green by default, blue or any colour). **Fill and key**: fill on one display, key (white where the scene shows) on the other. A plain M1 drives one extra display; Pro and Max chips drive more.
Blackmagic	An UltraStudio or DeckLink with Blackmagic Desktop Video installed, and the device free	**Fill and key** through the device's external keyer (fill on one SDI out, key on the other), or fill only, at the switcher's 1080p format (1080p50 is picked first). The fill is premultiplied: turn the switcher's Pre Multiplied Key on for clean edges, and leave Straight off (it leaves a light fringe round logos and text).
NDI®	NDI's free runtime for Mac, and a wired network	Fill and key as two sources, chroma as one, or one source with transparency for receivers that key on NDI's alpha. They appear as this Mac's name with the output's name in brackets (or a name of your own).

MORE THAN ONE OUTPUT

One output is all most nights need. To give a camera its own graphics, press **Add an output** beside Output on (up to four). Each output is its own picture with its own route and its own on/off, so a second output can feed an upstream keyer tied to a camera and its graphics cut with that camera, while Output 1 stays the downstream key over everything. Name an output in its card ("Wide camera", say) and that name is used everywhere, including its Stream Deck links.

- **Sources are shared, on/off is per output.** Each source in the list has a coloured pill per output (orange, pink, blue, green for Outputs 1 to 4). Press a pill to show or hide that source on that output only. A new output starts with everything off. The **Show** filter above the list narrows it to one output.
- **Output 1 is the primary.** It carries all the sound and music; the other outputs are graphics only and always silent.
- **Scenes and sequences are shared; each output plays its own.** Pick an output's tab over the Scene View and clicking a scene or sequence plays it on that output (the sections say which). **Hide all** clears that output only (or the one the Sources list's **Show** is set to), and says which, so clearing a monitor never blanks the stream. Each output

has its own current scene and plays one sequence at a time, so the same scene or sequence can be on two outputs at once; coloured dots on scene cards, and on sequence cards each output's tick with how the sequence is there (Playing, Paused, Starting or Stopped (it ended there, played out or cut short); a hollow dot and "off" while that output isn't sending), show where each one is on. A sequence's **Plays on** ticks (on its card and in its editor) pick the outputs it plays on together: started by itself, or played on any of them, it starts on all of them at once, and each output has its own **Then** for when it ends there, so a quarter-time sequence can go back to the live scene on Output 1 while the commentary monitor goes on to its stats loop. Played on an output it isn't ticked for, it plays there alone (`/deck/output/2/sequence/<name>/only` does that on a ticked one). Stop on a card stops it on that output only. Remove every output it plays on and the sequence stops starting by itself until you tick another, so it never lands on air by surprise. Off Output 1 a sequence plays silently; a Sponsor ads step still plays its ads there, in that output's own ad sources. `/deck/scene/<name>` and `/deck/sequence/<name>` play on Output 1; `/deck/output/2/scene/<name>`, `/deck/output/2/sequence/<name>`, `/deck/output/2/scene/next` and `/deck/output/2/sequence/stop` (and the rest) play on Output 2.

- **Sponsors count on Output 1, and on outputs you tick.** An extra output's card has **Counts for sponsors**, off to start. Tick it only when everything on that output is seen on the stream, like a second downstream key. Leave it off for a camera's upstream key or the commentary monitor: Studio can't tell when they're on air, and the report shouldn't claim time nobody saw. Ads there show whose turn it is without using it up, so the order on air stays fair.
- **The Scene View has a tab per output**, coloured to match, so you can check what each one is sending.
- **Routes can't be shared.** Two outputs can't use the same display, the Blackmagic device or the same NDI name; the earlier output keeps it and the later one says so on its card. Two HDMI displays give either two chroma outputs or one fill and key output. Several NDI outputs can run at once, each with its own name, which suits feeding a switcher's inputs over the network.
- **Stream Deck.** `/deck/output/2/toggle` (or the output's name) turns Output 2 on or off, `/deck/output/all/off` turns them all off, and `/deck/output/2/layer/<source>/toggle` shows or hides a source on Output 2. Source settings lists these links for each output.

EACH OUTPUT COSTS

Every extra output runs its pages once more on the Mac. Try the number of outputs you plan to use on your own Mac before a stream night: while an output is on, its card shows its CPU, memory and frame rate (amber when it can't keep up), with Studio's total under the status, and the log notes them once a minute.

A COMMENTARY MONITOR

Commentators can have graphics of their own: a monitor at the commentary desk with the live stats they talk to, never seen on the stream. The **Commentator stats** page is

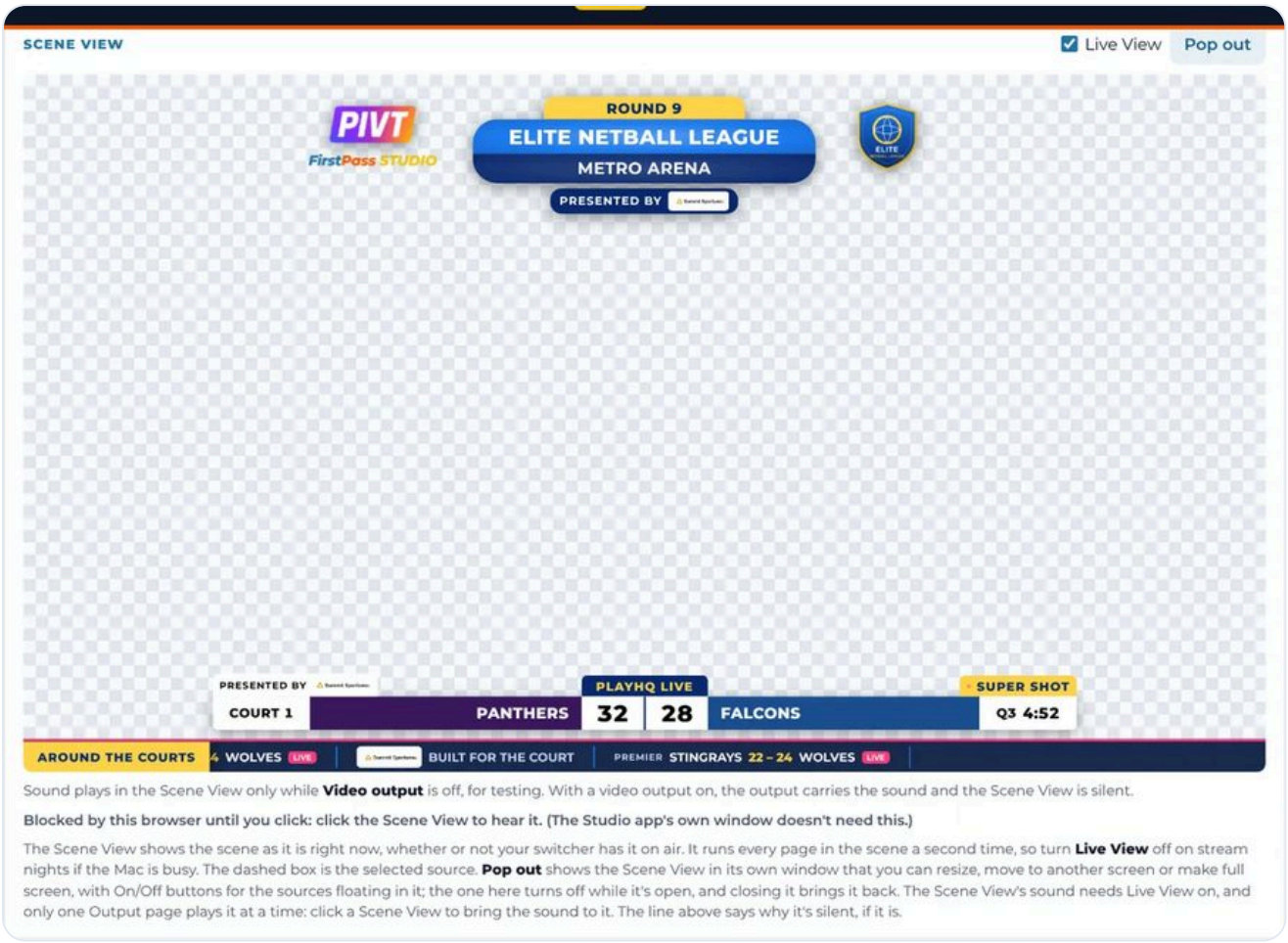
made for it: one full screen with both team lists on the left (each team's time since its last goal, and each athlete's games played this season), the game stats big in the middle (each team's logo with its ladder position, record and form under it, head to head under the names, then shooting %, quarters won, best quarter, super shots, runs, biggest lead and lead changes), down the right the game clock with the super shot window, who is on the mic (from the Production Planner) and up next, then a list of the latest moments (lead changes, comebacks, super shots, hot streaks), newest at the top, each with its quarter, game time and how long ago it happened, and across the bottom the last 10 goals, the current run in big numbers and the score worm. Its stats refresh themselves every 15 seconds and when the score changes (untick **Auto-refresh** in its options, or pick another frequency), and the clock, moments and goals follow the game as it happens. Other graphics can go on the commentary feed too: the last 10 goals and the scoreboard follow the game live, and the rest show what they read each time they come on.

- **On the same Mac.** Add an output for the commentary monitor (a display, or NDI to a screen on the network) and turn sources on for it with its pills or its Stream Deck keys, such as `/deck/output/commentary/layer/ladder/toggle`. Play scenes and sequences on it from its Scene View tab or its own Stream Deck links while the stream carries on as normal.
- **On a second Mac.** Run Studio on another Mac with the same competition and game, and Follow PlayHQ on. It reads PlayHQ's live scoring for itself, so it needs nothing from the stream Mac. Its Output 1 goes to the commentary monitor, and everything on it is for the commentators.

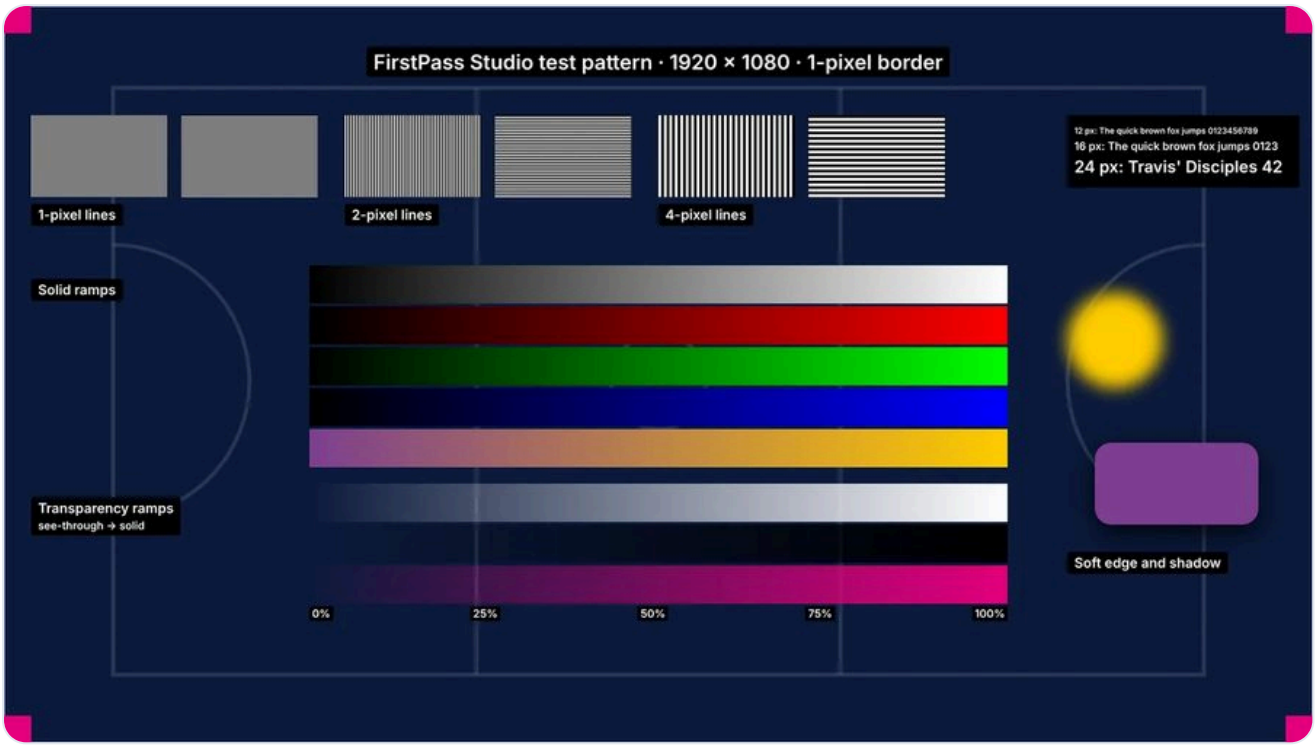
On the commentary output (or the second Mac), make a **commentaryLoop** sequence that steps through what commentators find useful (game stats, shooting stats, the last 10 goals, the ladder) with **Repeat** set to until stopped, and give the commentators a Stream Deck of their own:

- A key per graphic they want on demand, each going to a scene with that graphic (on the same Mac, `/deck/output/commentary/scene/ladder`). Going to a scene stops the loop on that output only, so their pick stays up and the stream is untouched.
- A **Loop** key to go back to looping when they're done: `/deck/output/commentary/sequence/commentaryloop` on the same Mac, or `/deck/sequence/commentaryloop` on a second Mac. With the FirstPass Studio plugin, use Scene and Sequence keys with **Output** set to the commentary output; they light pink while it's on.

Sound plays through the Mac's audio output on every route, from Output 1 only. The **Scene View** on the Output page shows the scene as it is right now, on a checkerboard so see-through parts show; **Pop out** opens it in its own window to move to another screen, with a floating list of On/Off buttons. The Scene View plays sound only while Video output is off, so it never plays twice.



The Scene View: the scene right now. Untick Live View on a busy night, since it runs the scene's pages a second time.



The **test pattern** (Add page) checks an output and the switcher's key end to end: a 1-pixel border, fine lines that shimmer if anything is resizing the picture, ramps for banding and soft shapes for the key. Not for air.

CHROMA KEY SAFE

A chroma key cuts out one colour, so anything half see-through fringes. With a chroma output picked, **Chroma key safe** is on: every graphic goes out with solid panels, no glows or soft shadows, and fades become cuts. Pick another output and everything is back as it was. The Output page also lists any competition or club colour close to the key colour.

THE SWITCHER

Studio can also drive a Blackmagic ATEM switcher over the network, so the camera cuts can be pressed from the Output page or a Stream Deck beside the graphics. Open the **Switcher** card under Video output, press **Set up** and **Look for switchers**: Studio finds the ATEMs on the network the way ATEM Software Control does (macOS asks the first time to let it use the local network) and remembers the one you pick by name. Typing its address works too.

- **Each output's key, checked.** In each output's setup, **Into the switcher as** says which switcher key its graphics come into (usually downstream key 1 for Output 1, upstream keys 2 to 4 for the others, an upstream key for chroma) and which inputs its fill and key are plugged into. Studio reads that key's settings and lists anything that doesn't suit the output, such as the wrong fill source, Pre Multiplied Key off, or Straight ticked on a Blackmagic output. **Set up this key for me** fixes just those, after asking, and leaves the key on or off air as it was.

- **Graphics that go with a camera.** An output on an upstream key can tick the cameras it **goes with**, say a bench graphic with the bench camera. Studio's cuts, autos and stingers then bring its key on with those cameras and take it off with the others, on the same frame. With **Keys follow the camera** on, a cut on the switcher's own panel brings the key a frame or two later. A key turned off by hand stays off until the camera changes. The output's card says **On air with Bench** or **Waiting for Bench**.
- **Inputs in tally colours.** Each input shows by its name from ATEM Software Control, red on program and green on preview. Click one to put it on preview, then **Cut** or **Auto**. Fade to black and each upstream and downstream key are a press away too.
- **Only what your switcher has.** An ATEM Mini or Mini Pro has 4 inputs, one upstream key and one downstream key, so fill and key into the downstream key leaves two cameras; a Mini Extreme has 8 inputs, four upstream keys and two downstream keys. Studio offers what it finds, and says so when a key or link asks for something the switcher doesn't have.
- **Your hands stay on the switcher.** Its own buttons, ATEM Software Control and other controllers keep working, and the card follows them. Studio sends nothing by itself, not even on connecting.
- **If it drops off the network, or is off when Studio connects,** the card turns red within about five seconds and Studio keeps trying. Presses meanwhile are refused rather than saved up, so a cut never lands late.
- **Stinger cuts.** Add the Stinger page as a source and the card's **Stinger** button plays it and cuts the switcher underneath, right in the middle of the bands. It plays on the output on a downstream key, which is Output 1 unless another output that's switched on is. If the cut shows before the bands do (an output's picture can reach the switcher a few frames late, more over NDI), set the **line-up** in frames and press **Test the line-up** before you go live. Each output keeps its own line-up.
- **Camera cuts in sequences and scenes.** A sequence step's 🎥 button, or a scene's 🎥 **Switcher** under Edit scenes, adds switcher actions: cut, auto or stinger to a camera, put one on preview, a key on or off, fade to black, or run a macro, as the step starts or a set number of seconds in. So the walk-out sequence can cut to the bench camera as the line-ups come up and bring the scoreboard key back as it ends, with nobody on the switcher. They happen only on Output 1, and if the switcher isn't answering at that moment the action is skipped and logged rather than done late. You can always cut by hand on the switcher itself.
- **Stream Deck.** The plugin's **Switcher** key puts a camera on preview or program, plays a stinger, cuts, autos, turns a key on or off or runs a macro, and lights like the switcher's own buttons: red on program, green on preview. While the switcher isn't answering it goes dark with a yellow dot. Without the plugin, the links are `/deck/switcher/cut`, `auto` and `ftb`, `/deck/switcher/preview/2` (or `preview/Camera%202`), `/deck/switcher/usk/1/toggle`, `/deck/switcher/dsk/1/auto` and `/deck/switcher/macro/1`.

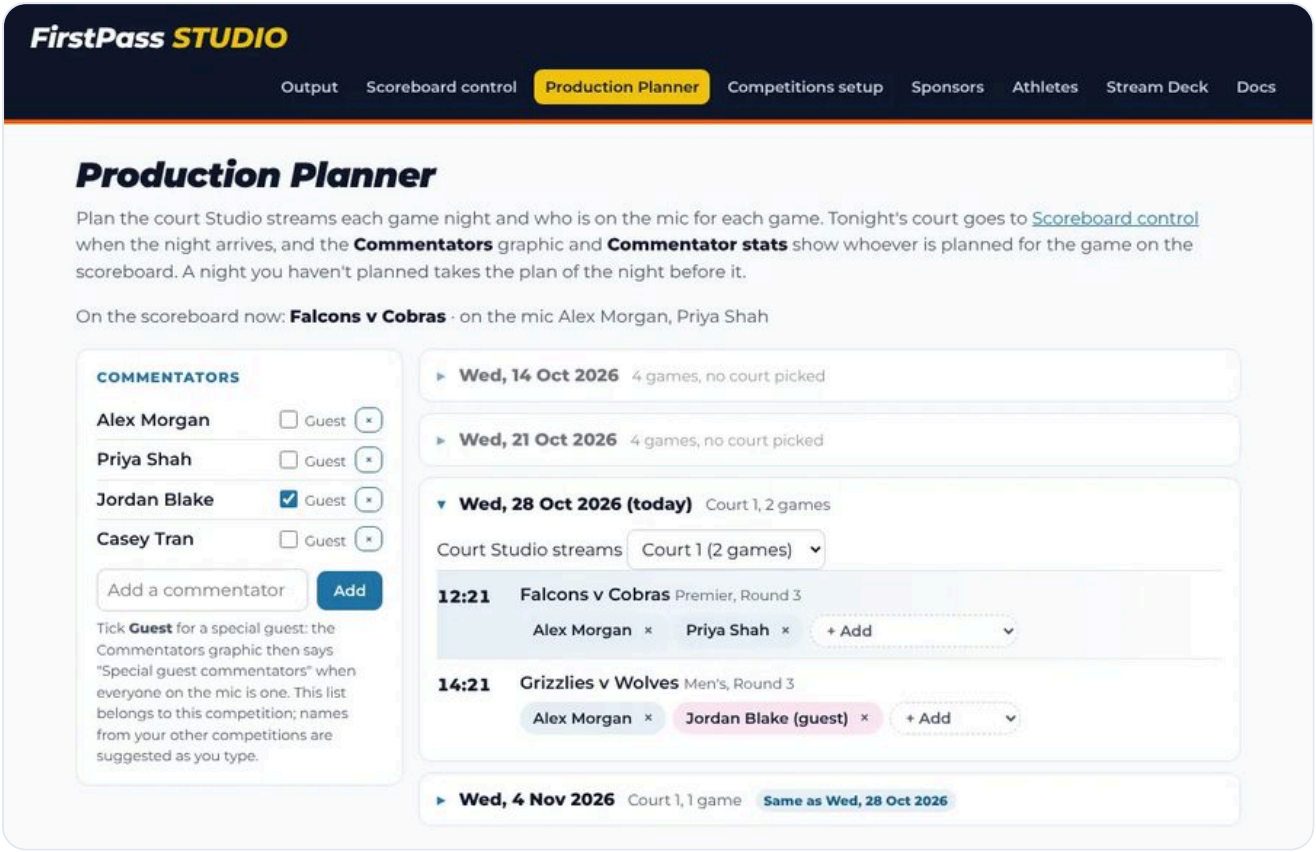
A night, start to finish

With the sample league's scenes and sequences, a solo operator's evening looks like this. Everything in the right-hand column happens by itself.

ARRIVE	Open the app. Studio goes on air, picks tonight's first game on Court 1 with Follow PlayHQ on. Turn the video output on and check the test pattern on the switcher.
15 MIN OUT	**Run-up** starts by itself: the Pre-game scene, then the sponsor wall, match up and ladder in turn over the warm-up playlist, repeating until 2 minutes before the start.
2 MIN OUT	Run-up hands over to **Walk out**: The Clash smashes the two logos together, the position match ups run through GS to GK, the countdown holds until the clock starts, then the Live game scene comes up and the music fades.
Q1 TO Q4	The scoreboard follows the PlayHQ scorer's score, quarter and clock. Super shots, hot streaks and moments play by themselves. The super shot tab and song mark the last five minutes of each quarter. The operator watches the stream and, if they like, keys up a ladder lower third or a lower third for a commentator.
QUARTER TIME	**Quarter time** starts a few seconds after the siren: shooting stats, the last 10 goals and the ladder, then two sponsor ads and the sponsor card, over the break music, round and round until play resumes, then back to Live game.
HALF TIME	**Half time** does the same with Up next and the ladder lower third added, and the house ad if no sponsor has one due.
FULL TIME	**Full time** starts after the final siren: the winner celebration, the full time card, game stats, the score worm, a sponsor break and Up next (which becomes the end-of-night card after the last game).
NEXT GAME	Automatic selection moves the board to the next game on Court 1 as its electronic scoring opens, with the quarter back to Q1 and a full clock. Run-up starts again 15 minutes out.
CLOSE	Press **Stream close**: the Clear scene, then the outro with the night's teams. Turn the output off. The sponsor report has the night's exposure ready to send.

The Production Planner

The **Production Planner** tab plans the season ahead: which court Studio streams each game night, and who is on the mic for each game. Studio streams one court a night; a second court is a second Mac running its own Studio, with its own plan.



The Production Planner: the commentators down the side, and the season's game nights from PlayHQ, the next one open, with each game on the night's court and who calls it.

COMMENTATORS

Add the people who call your games to the list on the left. Tick **Guest** for a special guest. The list belongs to the competition; as you type a name, people from your other competitions are suggested, so someone who calls in two leagues is added in a tap. Click the circle beside a name, or drop a photo on the row, to add their **headshot** for the Socials tab's Commentary team picture; the small × on it takes it off again.

A NIGHT

Every game night in the season is listed, read from PlayHQ's fixture, by date rather than round. Open one, pick the **Court Studio streams**, and its games on that court appear in time order. Tap **+ Add** on a game to put up to three people on the mic; tap × to take someone off. Everything saves as you go. A night you haven't planned takes the plan of the night before it (the same court, and the same people game by game), marked **Same as** that night, so a season with a regular team is planned once and only the nights that differ need changing. **Same as the night before** drops a night's own plan again.

WHEN THE FIXTURE CHANGES

PlayHQ's fixture changes through a season: a game moves court for availability, or is refixtured to another date. The commentators belong to the time on the court, because that is where the desk and cameras are set up, so they stay put and the game is flagged **Fixture changed** with what was there before. A game that has gone from the court keeps its row, so its commentators can be moved to wherever it went.

ON THE NIGHT

When the night arrives, the plan's court goes to Scoreboard control, which follows it game by game as usual. The **Commentators** graphic, with no names typed in its options, names whoever is planned for the game on the scoreboard, and says **Special guest commentators** when everyone on the mic is a guest. **Commentator stats** shows them under the clock, and the **Fixture board** full page puts the whole night's fixture on a screen in the competition room or backstage, with a camera on the streamed court's games and who is on the mic for each. Manual control always wins: if you change the court or pick a game by hand on Scoreboard control, the Planner says so at the top, so the commentary team can be moved to match. Swapping someone in the Planner takes effect the next time the graphic comes on.

Socials

The **Socials** tab turns a game night into pictures for Instagram and the league's other channels, from the same fixture the stream uses, so the posts and the broadcast always agree. Pick the **Game night** (by date, so every division playing that night is in it), **Upcoming** or **Results** (a night with results opens on Results), and the sizes: **Square** 1080 × 1080, **Portrait** 1080 × 1350 (the most room in the feed) and **Story** 1080 × 1920. Every picture shows as a preview in each size, in the competition's colours, font and logos.

UPCOMING PICTURES

The **Game night fixture** lists every game of the night on every court, by time. A **Match up** for each game puts the two logos side by side with the date, time, court and venue, one for each club to share. **On the stream** shows the court Studio streams, with each game's division and who calls it, from the Production Planner. **Commentary team** puts the commentators side by side with their headshots, to share before the livestream. It takes two to a picture so the faces stay big, and a night with more commentators gets a picture for each pair; anyone without a headshot shows their initials, and a guest gets a **Special guest** pill. The **Polaroid** is a tilted white print for a match photo: drop a photo on it, drag the preview to frame it and set the zoom. With no photo, its window is see-through, so the social team can put their own photo under it in Canva or a phone app.

RESULTS PICTURES

After the night, **Results** shows every finished game's final score, division by division, with the winner in the highlight colour. Each game gets a **Full time** card, with the logos and score big and who won by how much, and a **Polaroid** with the score as its caption. Each division that played gets its **Ladder**, with the finals line, labelled "after" the round when it is that division's latest night with results. **Top shooters** names the night's best six across every division, from each game's line ups. A game appears once PlayHQ has its final score.

SPONSORS, THE LOGOS AND SAVING

Each picture has a **Sponsor strip** tick, which puts your naming, elite and major sponsors along the bottom and is remembered for next week. **FirstPass Studio mark** (bottom right) and **PIVT logo** (bottom left) turn those on or off for every picture. **Template** sets the look of every picture: **Default** is the stream's own, and Fun, Dynamic, Junior, Retro, Futuristic, Professional, Thunder, Geometric, Gradient, Striped, High contrast, 3D, Neon, Poster, Splash, Game Day, Arena, Hero and Final each bring their own shapes and lettering, and three netball sets draw on the game itself: Court (the court's lines and circles), Bib (a bib with its position letters) and Goal (the ring, net and post). Any template works with any colours. Athletes' photos come from the Athletes page, and only for athletes ticked **Approved for photo use**. Top shooters shows each shooter's photo automatically. On a Match up, Full time or Polaroid card, pick an athlete by name, narrowing the list by division and team. Hero and Final stand the picked athletes tall, in front of the title; a cut-out PNG with a transparent background looks best. **Colours** gives every picture a different look: **Competition colours** is the stream's own, and the others swap the competition's main, highlight and accent colours around (Accent first, Highlight ground, Accent ground), or go darker (Night), paler (Day) or down to two colours. **New colour set** makes your own from three colours, for a finals night or a sponsor round. A set marked **low contrast** has titles that may be hard to read. Your choice is remembered for the competition. Untick anything you don't want (**Select all** and **Select none** tick or untick every picture at once), then **Save pictures**: they are saved as PNGs in a folder for the night in **Pictures › FirstPass Studio**, which opens in Finder. **Share…** saves them too and opens the Mac's Share menu, to AirDrop them to your phone or send them by Messages or Mail. Tick **As a zip** to also save them as one .zip beside the folder; Share then sends that one file, which is easier to email or upload.

Running it by hand

When nobody is live-scoring the game on PlayHQ, or PlayHQ stops answering mid-game, every automatic part of Chapter 3 has a button. The board, the breaks and the celebrations can all be driven from Scoreboard control and a Stream Deck.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Two people, not one
2 Switching to manual
3 The score
4 The clock and the quarter
5 Breaks and celebrations by hand
6 Finals

Studio still needs the competition on PlayHQ for its fixture, ladder, squads and results; what changes in manual mode is who runs the score and the clock. The same competition can be followed one week and run by hand the next, and nothing on the Output page changes between the two.

Two people, not one

A followed game can be run by one person because the score, the clock and the breaks take care of themselves. A game run by hand is a different job: someone has to press a key for every goal within a second or two of it, start and stop the clock with the umpire's whistle, and still call the breaks and the graphics. We recommend two people share it:

Camera operator

- Frames and follows play on the cameras, and cuts between them on the switcher.
- Runs the game clock from the whistle, with **Start / Stop** and **Reset clock** keys beside the camera controls.
- Scores the goals as they go in, **+1** or **+2**, because they are already watching the ring.
- Nothing else: no graphics, no breaks, no music.

Production manager

- Keeps the Output page open and watches the stream itself, not the court.
- Corrects the score (**−1**, **−2**) and the quarter, and sets the clock when it drifts from the venue's.
- Plays the run-up, break and full time sequences from their keys, and the lower thirds, ladders and stats during play.
- Runs the music, the sponsor ads and the end of night, and picks the finals winners.

If one person must do it alone, keep the Stream Deck to the score and clock keys and let the sequences do the breaks, exactly as they do in automated mode: the game triggers follow the scoreboard's clock whoever runs it.

Switching to manual

Press **Manual** on Scoreboard control, or just press any score key: either switches the board to manual scoring and stops following the PlayHQ clock as well. Press **Follow PlayHQ** to go back; the score catches up with PlayHQ on the next check and the clock follows the scorer's again.



Score and clock on Scoreboard control. Keyboard: A and Z for the home team, K and M for away, Shift for a super shot, Space for the clock.

WHEN PLAYHQ DROPS OUT

If PlayHQ stops answering during a followed game, the scoreboard keeps its last score, the ladder, fixtures and game list keep what they last read, and the debug log records each failed read. Switch to Manual and run the board by hand; Follow PlayHQ picks it up again when PlayHQ is back, and corrects the score to the scorer's.

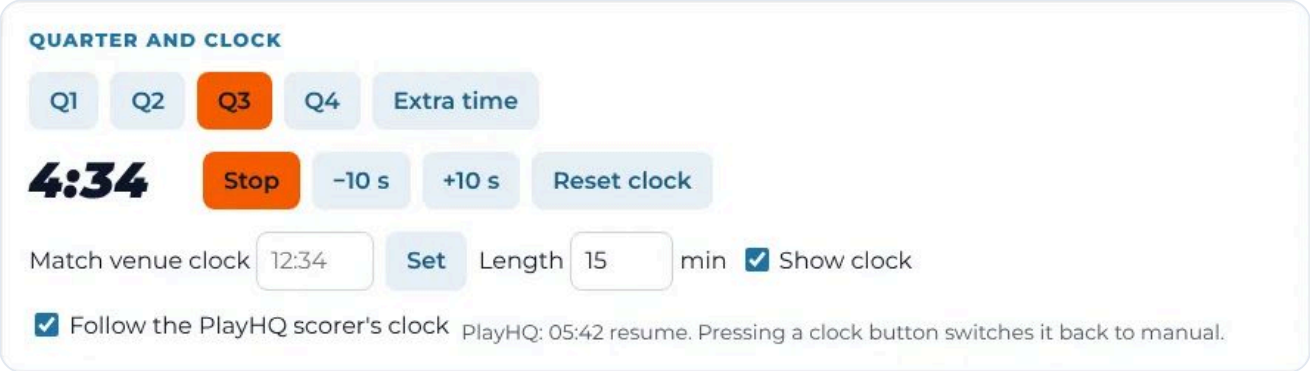
The score

Each team has **+1**, **+2**, **−1** and **−2**. A +2 is a super shot: it scores two and plays the super shot celebration, so a +2 pressed by mistake is fixed with −2 (which plays nothing). **Reset scores to 0** clears both. The hot streaks and game moments still play in manual mode, because Studio works out the goal order from the presses just as it does from PlayHQ's score.

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
Home +1 / Away +1	A goal.
Home +2 / Away +2	A super shot: two points and the celebration.
−1, −2	Take a goal or a super shot back, quietly.
Reset scores to 0	Both scores to zero, for the next game.
Super shot (home / away)	The celebration only, score unchanged: for a test, or a super shot that was scored as +1 +1.

The clock and the quarter

Start and **Stop** are one key on the Stream Deck. **Reset clock** puts a full quarter back (the competition's quarter length; a key can set any time). **+10 s** and **−10 s** nudge it, and a key can add or take off any amount. Type the venue's clock in **Match venue clock** to line the two up, and untick **Show clock** for a game with no reliable clock at all. Quarters are **Q1** to **Q4** plus extra time, or H1 and H2 for a competition played in halves; **Next quarter** steps through them. Changing the quarter doesn't touch the clock, so make the quarter key a Stream Deck Multi Action that also resets the clock.



Quarter and clock. The super shot tab, the super shot song and the break sequences all read this clock, so they work by hand as they do when following PlayHQ.

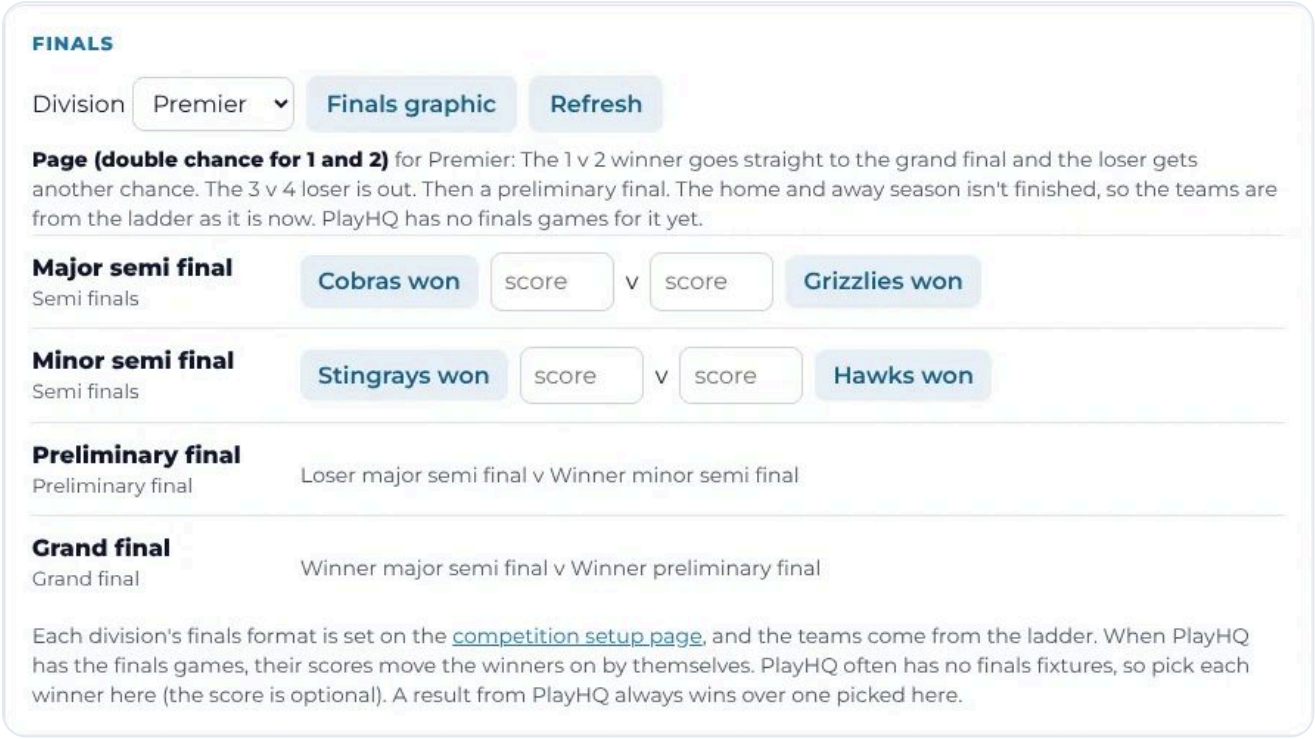
Breaks and celebrations by hand

A sequence that starts by itself at quarter time is started by its key too, so the production manager can run **Quarter time** the moment the siren goes instead of waiting for the clock, or run **Half time** early when a game is called. **Next**, **Pause** and **Stop** work on whatever is playing, and **Automatic sequences on** on the Output page can be unticked for a night where every break is called by hand.

- **Winner.** One key. The celebration reads the board's score when it comes on, so it covers a home win, an away win and a draw. Check the score first. A source with **Result** set to home, away or draw forces it.
- **Super shot and streaks, once.** Besides the automatic sources, a Super shot source set to **Plays: home** or **away**, or a Hot streaks source set to one streak, plays once each time it is turned on. Don't keep a manual source and the automatic one on together, or it plays twice.
- **The Clash.** A pre-game animation, played from its key or as a step in the walk-out sequence, with the two teams, their logos and club colours.
- **Lower thirds.** The person lower third's name box on the Output page suggests the competition's athletes; type a guest's name and title for a commentator or an official. Turn it on when they appear and off a few seconds later.
- **Stats during play.** The ladder lower third, shooting stats, last 10 goals and match up are all Source keys. Each loads fresh when shown, so it has the latest numbers.

Finals

PlayHQ often has no finals fixtures until the day. In **Finals** on Scoreboard control, pick the division, then pick each game's winner (the score is optional) as the finals are played; the finals graphic and the ladder's finals key move on with each pick. A result from PlayHQ, when it has one, always wins over one picked here.



Finals on Scoreboard control. The format for each division is set on the Competitions setup page, and the teams come from the ladder.

The graphics

Every graphic Studio draws, grouped by when it is used. Each one is added to the scene with **Add page** on the Output page, and its options appear as fields under its address; the options named here are the ones worth knowing.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Always on
2 Before the game
3 During play
4 After the game
5 The competition
6 The breaks
7 Checking the outputs

All of them follow the game night, game and court picked on Scoreboard control, take the competition's colours, font and logos from its setup, and fit long team names. Cards sit in the space between the title and the scoreboard and shrink to fit when they have more in them than fits. Every page, with its link and a Preview button, is also listed on the Docs tab.

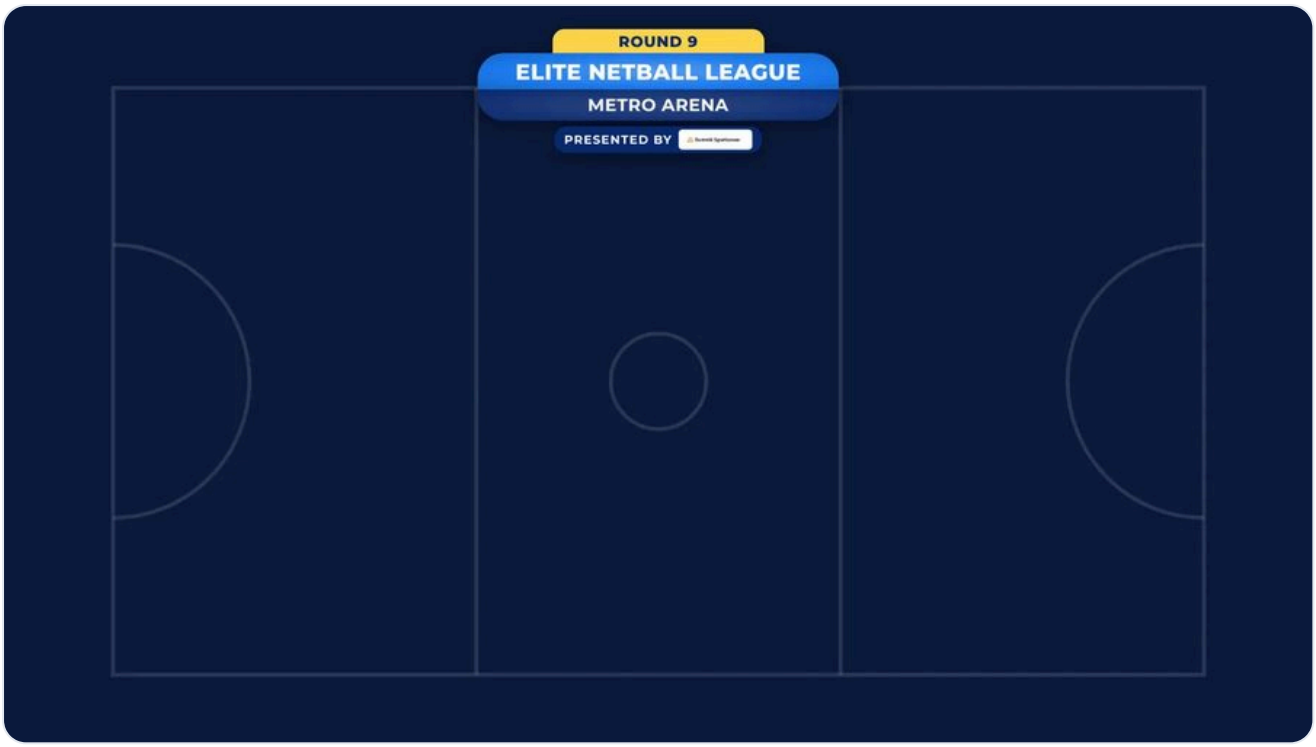
Always on



Scoreboard. Court, both teams with their logos and club colours, the score, the quarter and the clock, centred at the bottom above the ticker. Options: position (top centre, bottom left and so on), super shot tab on or off, and the naming-rights sponsor's tab.



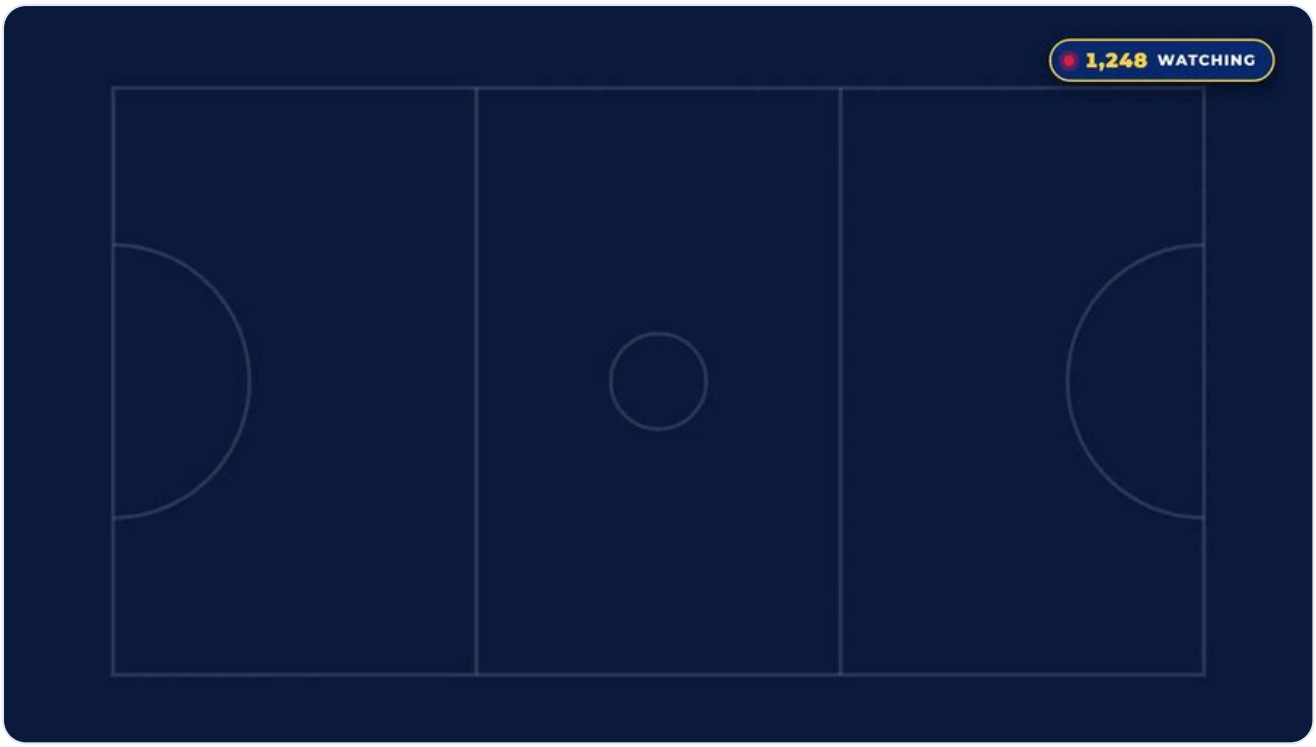
Score ticker. The scores from tonight's other games scrolling along the bottom, leaving out the game on the board, updated every 30 seconds. Speed from the control page or a Stream Deck key; a Partner sponsor's logo takes a slot in the line.



Title. Competition, round and venue in a banner at the top. Options: an emoji either side, the competition logo above it, top or bottom, and the naming-rights sponsor under it.



Branding logos. PIVT and FirstPass Studio left of the title, the competition logo right. Each can be hidden; gap, height and size adjust the placement.



Viewers. "N watching" from the competition's YouTube and Facebook streams, top right, shown only once the count passes the competition's minimum. **Shows: peak** makes it a card for the end of the night.

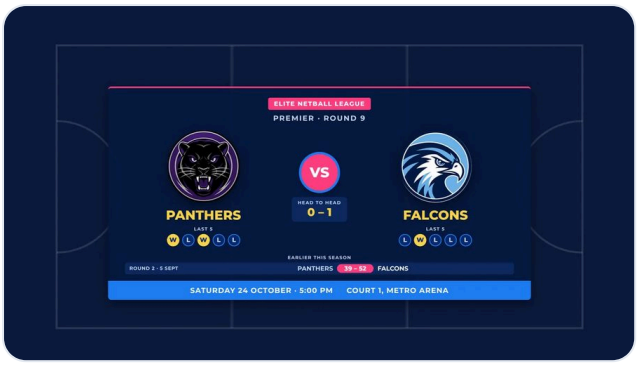
Before the game



Countdown. Counts down to the picked game's scheduled start, with the two teams. Options: heading, the words at zero, a fade over the last seconds, position and a sponsor.



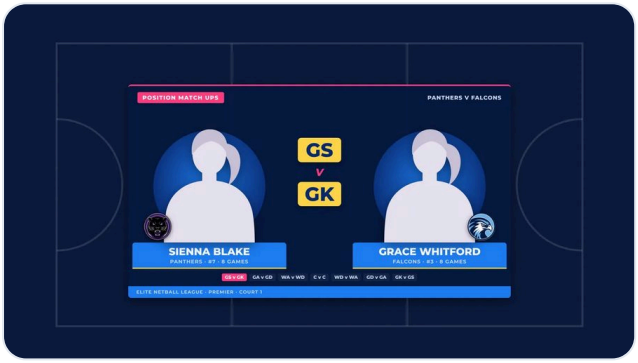
Up next. The next game on this court (or any court), with its time, teams and logos. After the last game it becomes the end-of-night card.



Match up. Both teams side by side with their last five results as form dots and this season's head to head. **Form** and **Head to head** can each be hidden.



The Clash. The two teams slam together behind a big word (IMPACT, CLASH, SHOWDOWN, your own) in their club colours. Options: the word, the bottom line, animate away after N seconds.



Position match ups. Who marks whom, position by position, with the athletes' photos from the Athletes page or a silhouette. Options: seconds per pairing, loop or stop, start with GS or GK, one pairing only, animate away at the end.



Position match ups, all seven. The same page can show every pairing at once as one card.

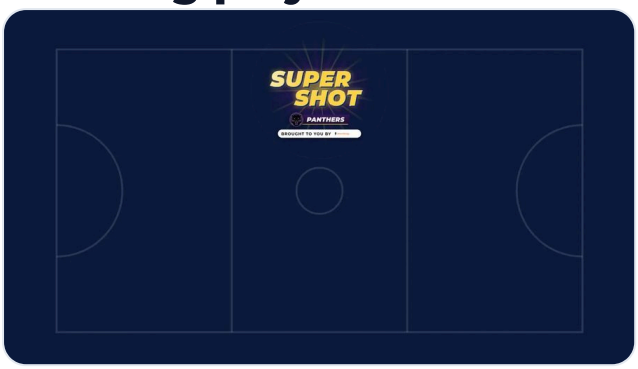


Team list. One team's line-up from PlayHQ with positions, captain and bench, warmed up before the game so it shows at once. Add one source per side.

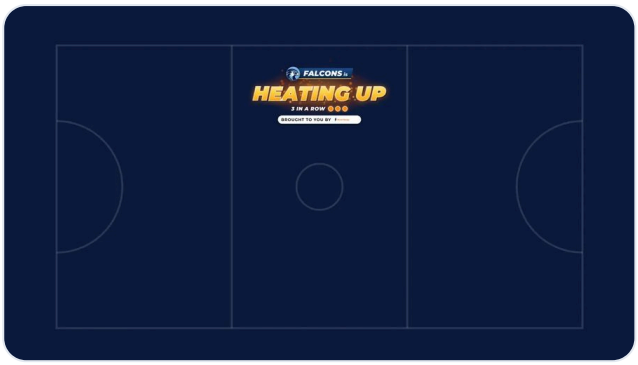


Intro and outro. Six full-screen styles, about 8 seconds, with the round's teams and a yellow message line. Options: style, teams from a division or round, time on screen, a theme song with its timing and volume, sound effects, a background.

During play



Super shot. Automatic, 3 seconds, the scoring team's logo and colour; the sponsored-moment tag names who brought it. **Plays: home / away / no team** makes a manual one.



Hot streaks and moments. Heating up, on fire, goal for goal, hits the front, all square, coming back, on the siren, back to back. Automatic from the goal order, or **Plays** picks one to play once.



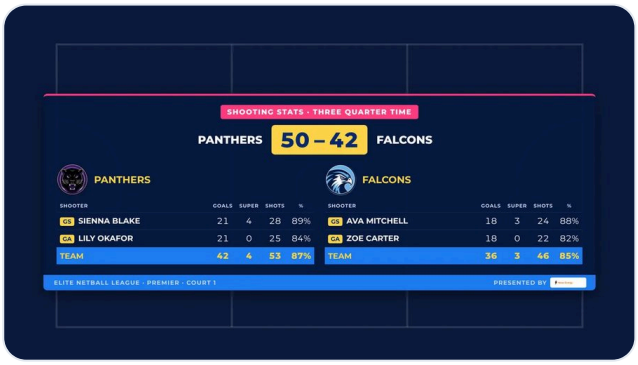
On the siren. A goal in the last seconds of a quarter. Moments are the only animations that need nothing from you; they also take the sponsor's "brought to you by" tag.



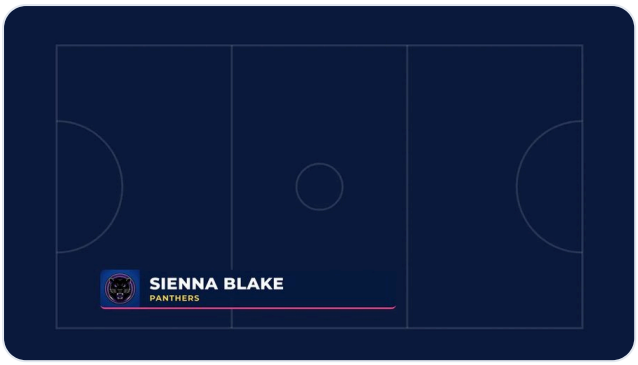
Ladder lower third. Both teams' ladder position and record as one strip right above the scoreboard, the same width as it, for a glance during play without covering the game.



Last 10 goals. The game's recent goals oldest to newest with a momentum line and the current run, worked out by Studio from the score, updating while it stays on. Options: across the top or down the side, how many goals, position and heading.



Shooting stats. Goals, super shots and attempts per shooter from PlayHQ's game page, for a break or a quarter-time sequence. Super columns are left off for a division without super shots.



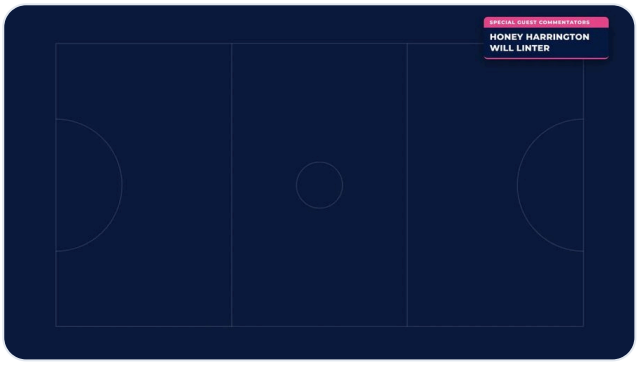
Person lower third, athlete. Name, team and club logo from the athlete register, with their photo if there is one. The Output page suggests names as you type.



Person lower third, guest. Name, title and the competition logo, for a commentator, an official or a sponsor's guest. Options: a tab above, position left or right, animate away.

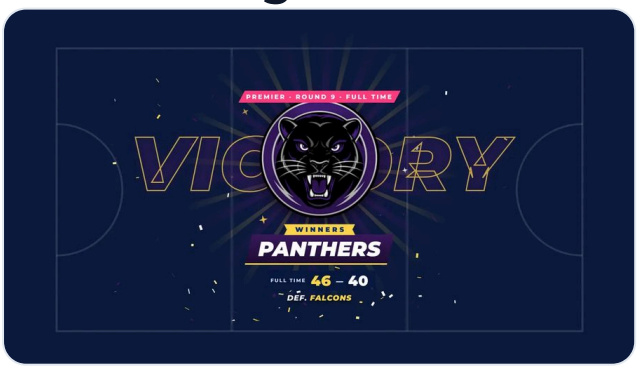


Commentators, thin line. The commentary team in one slim strip above the scoreboard: a pink tab, like Special guest commentators, and up to four names joined with "and". With no names typed, whoever the Production Planner has on the mic.



Commentators, box. The same names as an upper third in the top right corner beside the competition logo, a line per name. Options: under the title instead, the tab's words, animate away.

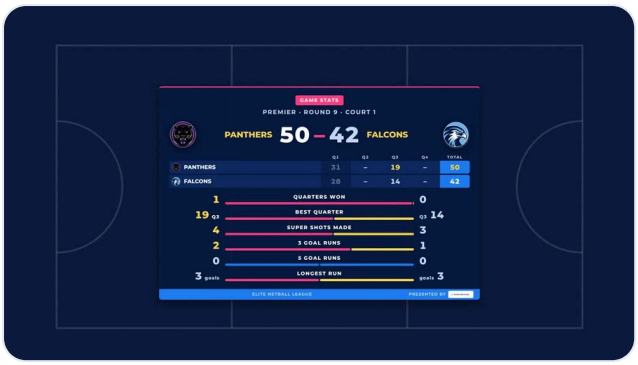
After the game



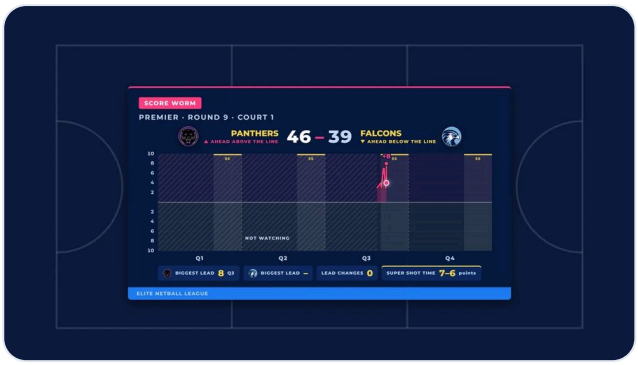
Winner. The winning team, logo, final score and a big word, worked out from the board each time it comes on. Options: force a result, the word, the line under the score, animate away.



Full time. The final score from the board with each team's top shooter and shooting accuracy from PlayHQ's game stats. **Heading** makes it a half time card.



Game stats. The score by quarter, tracked by Studio from the board, then team against team: quarters won, best quarter, super shots made, 3 and 5 goal runs and the longest run, with a sponsor's footer.



Score worm. The margin through the game as a line, drawn in over a few seconds. Options: drawing time, club colours or the competition's.



End of night. Up next after the last game: thanks for watching, next week's date or the finals, and the Supporter sponsors in a strip. Options: the invite line, sponsors on or off.

The competition



Ladder. The division's ladder with the finals places marked and a key under it. Options: division, rows, logo on or off, light or dark mode logo.



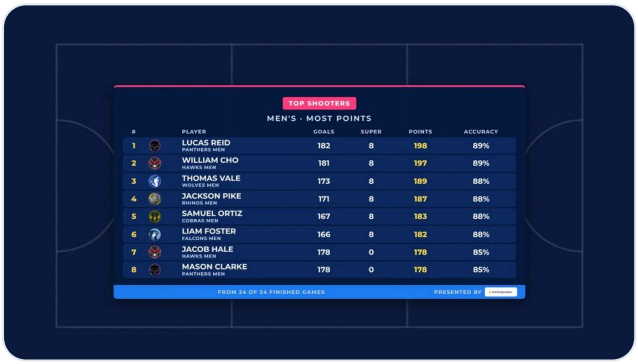
Round fixture. This round's games across all divisions with day, time and court. **Round** takes next, prev, +2, a number or a name like Final. When divisions are on different rounds, each game shows its own.



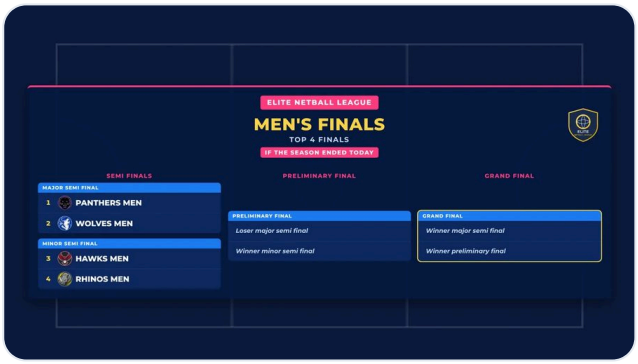
Fixture board (Full Page). The night's whole fixture by time and court, for a screen in the competition room or backstage, or a picture to share before the night (**Tuesday Night's Fixtures**). The streamed court has a camera and its games name the commentators from the Production Planner; games being played show their live score, and finished ones grey out with the winner in yellow. Not for the stream.



Results. The same round once its games are final, with scores. The same round option applies.



Top shooters. The season's leading shooters for a division. Options: order by goals or average, how many shooters, a sponsor footer.



Finals. Who plays whom week by week in the division's finals format, with ladder positions and scores; "If the season ended today" until the home-and-away rounds finish. Options: one week only, the heading and the line under it.

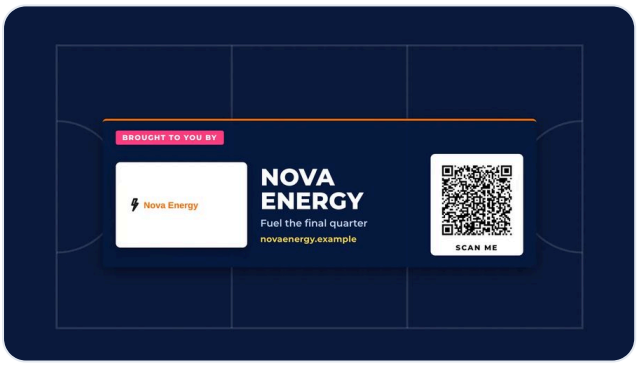


Competition logo animation. Seventeen templates (pro, coin, tiles, glitch, badge, lightning, court, bibs, net and more), about 5 seconds, with optional words and a smaller line.

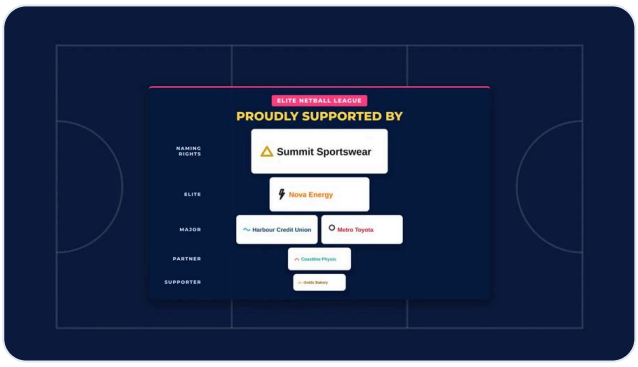


Stinger. A 1.5 second transition: bands in the competition's colours sweep across and cover the whole picture with the competition logo for half a second, so a cut can happen underneath, then carry on off the other side. Options: hold, length, logo on or off, light or dark mode logo, whoosh volume, and the music quieted for the next scene or dipped while it plays.

The breaks



Sponsor card. One sponsor's logo, tagline, offer and a QR code to their website, taking turns by tier. Options: one sponsor always, which tiers rotate, animate away.

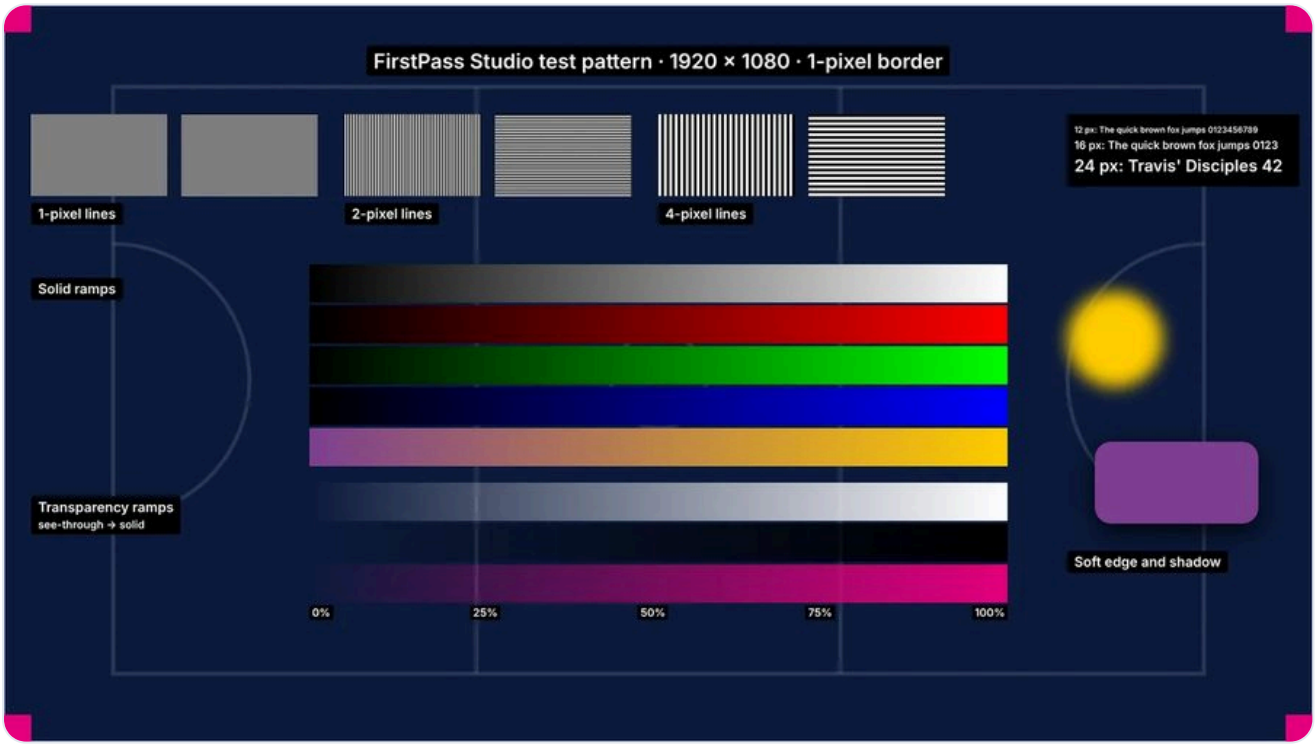


Sponsor wall. Every sponsor by tier on one card, for the run-up and the close. Options: which tiers, names under the logos.



PIVT and FirstPass Studio ad. A 10-second house ad for a break with nothing sold. A Sponsor ads step plays it when no sponsor's ad is due, if **House ad** is ticked.

Checking the outputs



Test pattern. Borders, fine lines, ramps and soft shapes to check an output, the switcher's scaling and its key end to end before the stream. Never for air.

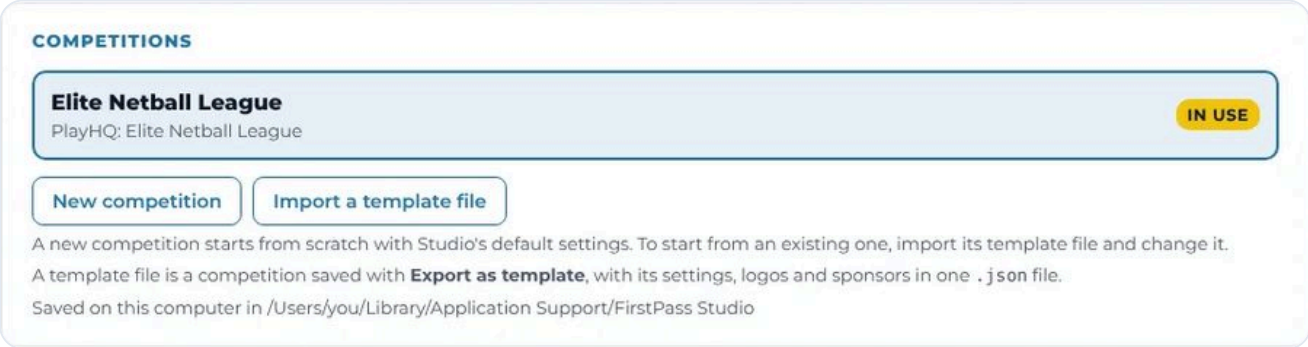
Competitions setup

Everything about a competition that doesn't come from PlayHQ lives on one page: its PlayHQ link, the names on the graphics, the game rules, finals, game day, colours, font and logos. Set it up once a season and every graphic follows.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 PlayHQ
2 Names on the graphics
3 Game rules
4 Finals
5 Game day
6 Colours and font
7 Logos
8 Live viewers
9 Templates, export and more

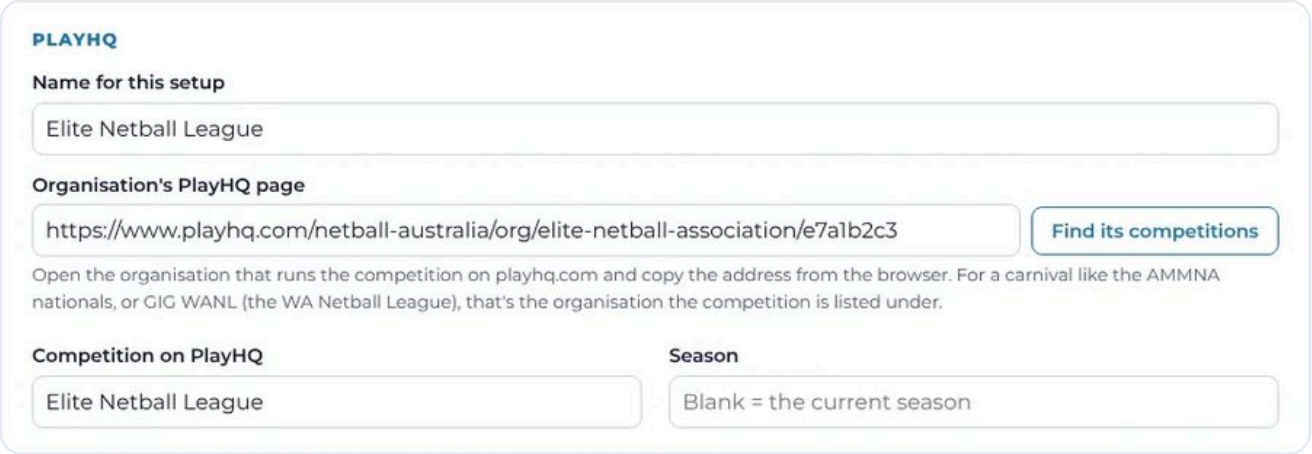
Studio keeps a setup per competition. The one marked **In use** is what every graphic, Scoreboard control, the Sponsors page and the Stream Deck use. Changes aren't kept until you press **Save** (or **Save and use this competition**), and leaving the page with unsaved changes asks first.



The competitions list. Start from a template file (the repository has Thunder League, AMMNA Nationals, GIG WANL and West Coast Thunder) or press New competition for Studio's defaults.

PlayHQ

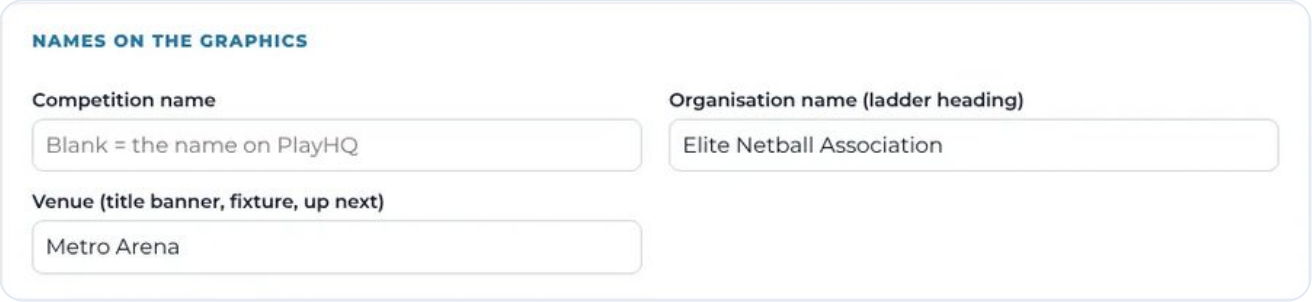
Paste the address of the organisation's page on playhq.com and press **Find its competitions**; then pick the competition and the season. For a carnival or a league run under another body, use the organisation the competition is listed under. Nothing else about PlayHQ is needed: no account, no key.



The PlayHQ section for the sample league. The season list comes from PlayHQ once the competition is picked.

Names on the graphics

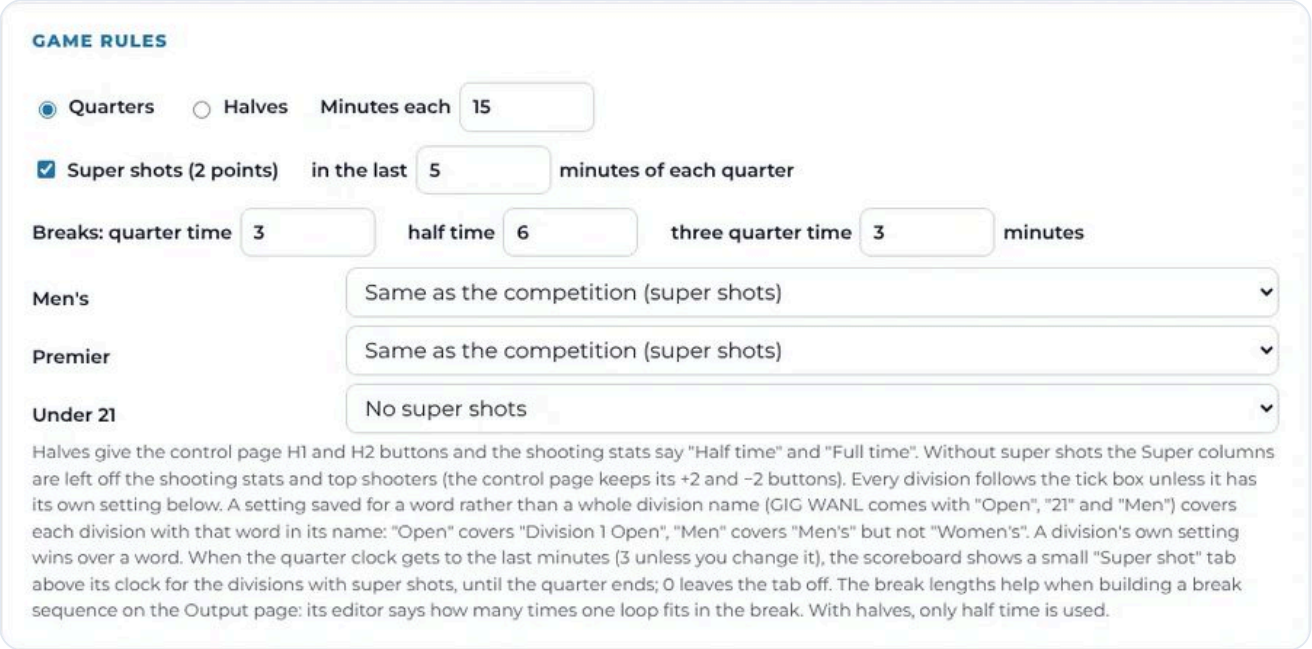
The competition name on the title banner, the organisation name as the ladder's heading, and the venue for the title, fixture and Up next. PlayHQ's names are often long or formal; these are the ones viewers see.



Names on the graphics.

Game rules

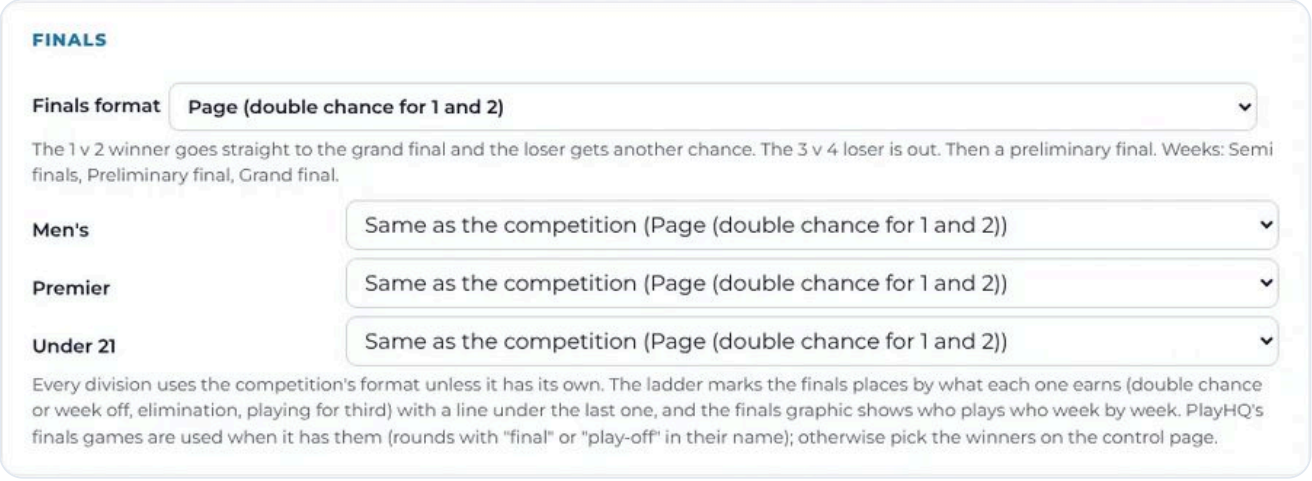
Quarters or halves and their length set the clock, the quarter buttons and the wording of the break cards. **Super shots** turns on the +2 scoring, the celebration, the super shot tab in the last minutes of each quarter and the Super columns on the shooting graphics; a division can have its own setting, by its name or by a word in it ("Open", "Men"). The break lengths let the sequence editor say how many loops of a break sequence fit in the break.



Game rules. The sample league plays 15-minute quarters with super shots in the last 5 minutes, except in its Under 21 division.

Finals

Pick the finals format for the competition, or per division: it decides the finals places the ladder marks (double chance or a week off, elimination, playing for third) and the bracket the finals graphic draws week by week. PlayHQ's finals games are used when it has them; otherwise the winners are picked on Scoreboard control.

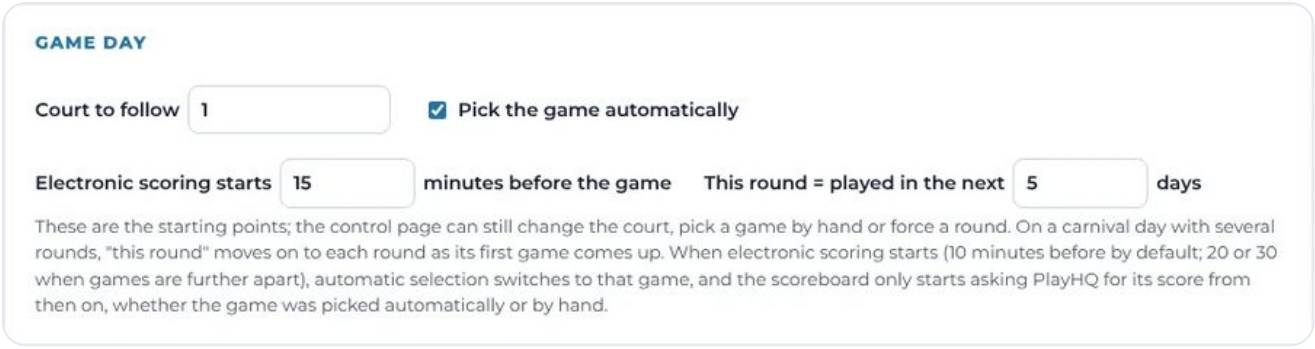


Finals formats, per division where they differ.

Game day

The court Studio follows, whether it picks the game automatically, when electronic scoring starts before each game (10 minutes by default; 20 or 30 when games are further apart) and how many days ahead tonight's games are found. These are starting

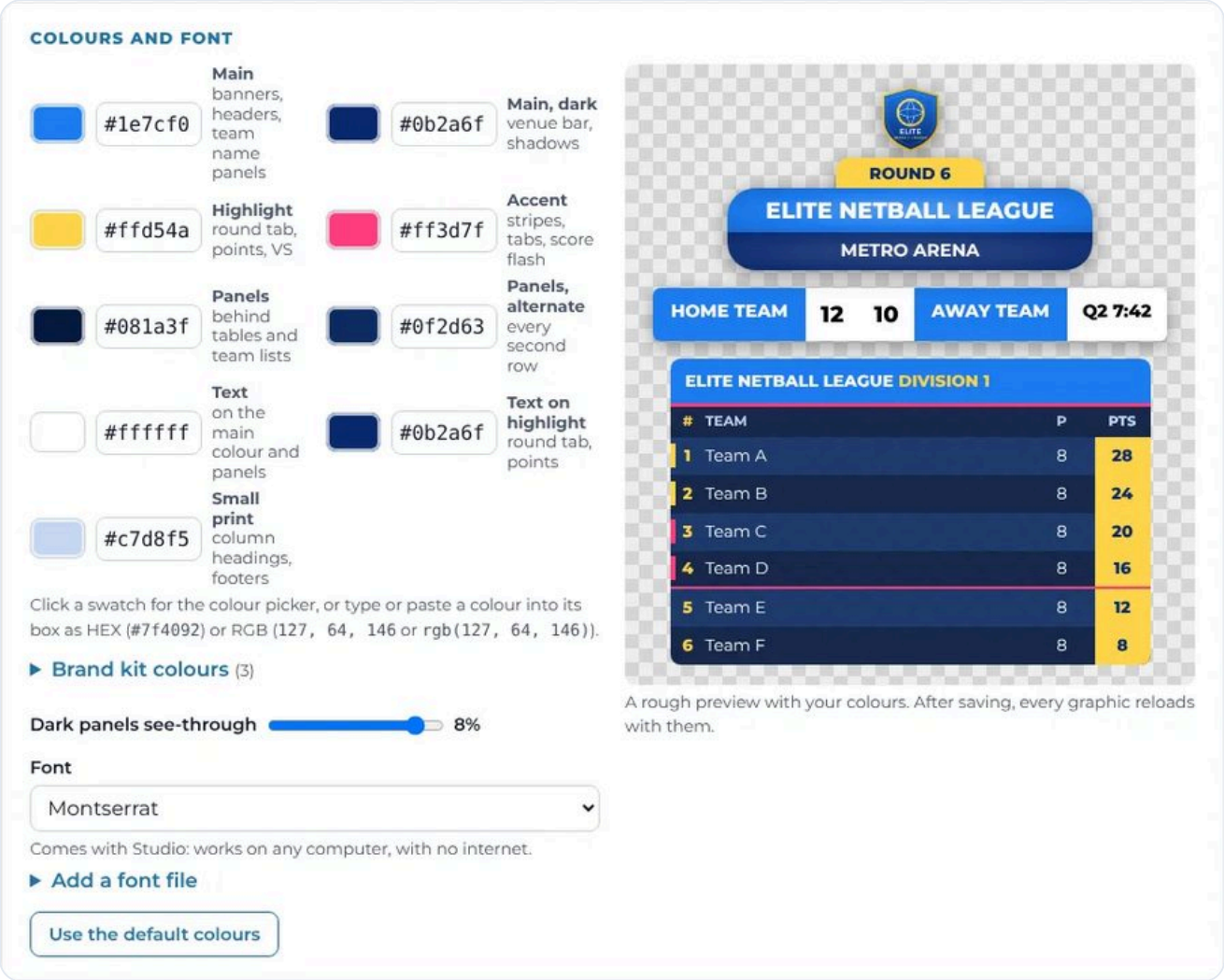
points: Scoreboard control can change the court, pick a game by hand or pick another game night. On a carnival day with several rounds, this round moves on as each round's first game comes up.



Game day.

Colours and font

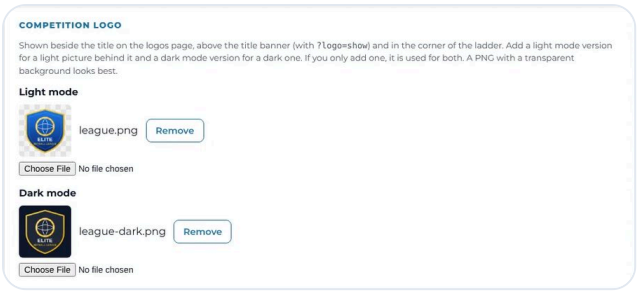
The competition's colours, see-through dark panels, and the font. Paste a brand kit's text into **Brand kit colours** and every HEX or RGB value in it becomes a swatch in each colour picker. Add a font file (TTF, OTF, WOFF or WOFF2, one per weight or a variable font) and it travels with the competition and its template, so the graphics look the same on any Mac; every font is sized to match the capitals of Montserrat, which the graphics were drawn with. The preview under the pickers shows a rough title and scoreboard in the colours before you save.



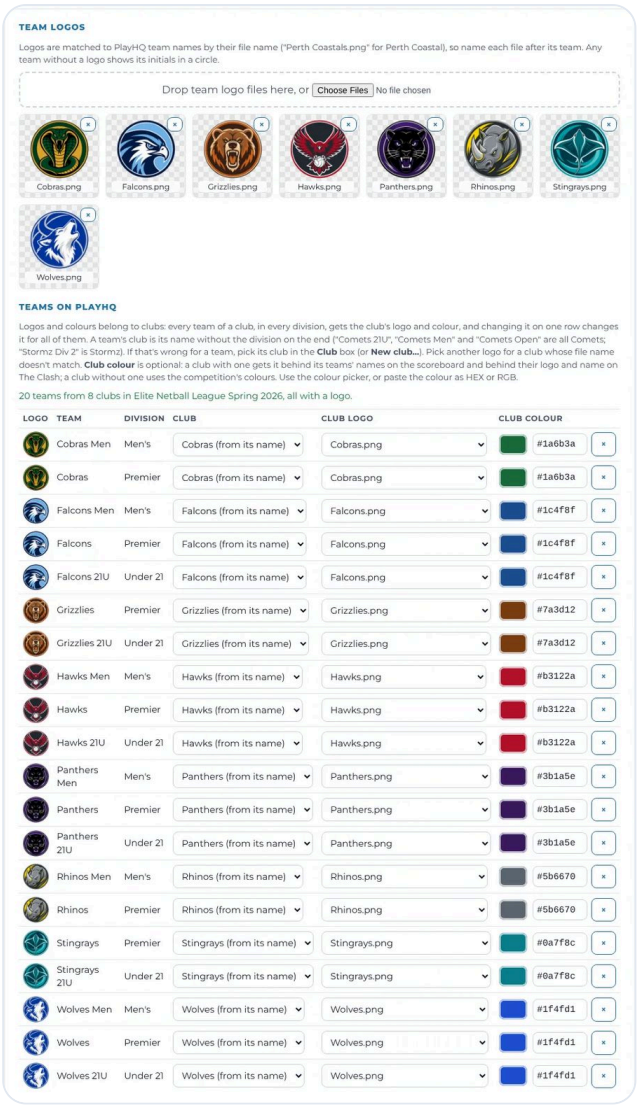
Colours and font, with the preview.

Logos

The **competition logo** has a light mode and a dark mode version (one is used for both if that's all you add); it shows beside the title in the branding logos, above the title with its option on, in the corner of the ladder and in the logo animations. **Team logos** are matched to PlayHQ team names by file name, so drop in a folder of files named after the teams. Logos and colours belong to clubs: every team of a club, in every division, gets the club's logo and colour, worked out from the team name without its division ("Falcons 21U" is Falcons). Fix a wrong match in the **Club** box. A club colour goes behind its teams' names on the scoreboard and behind their logo on The Clash; without one the competition's colours are used.



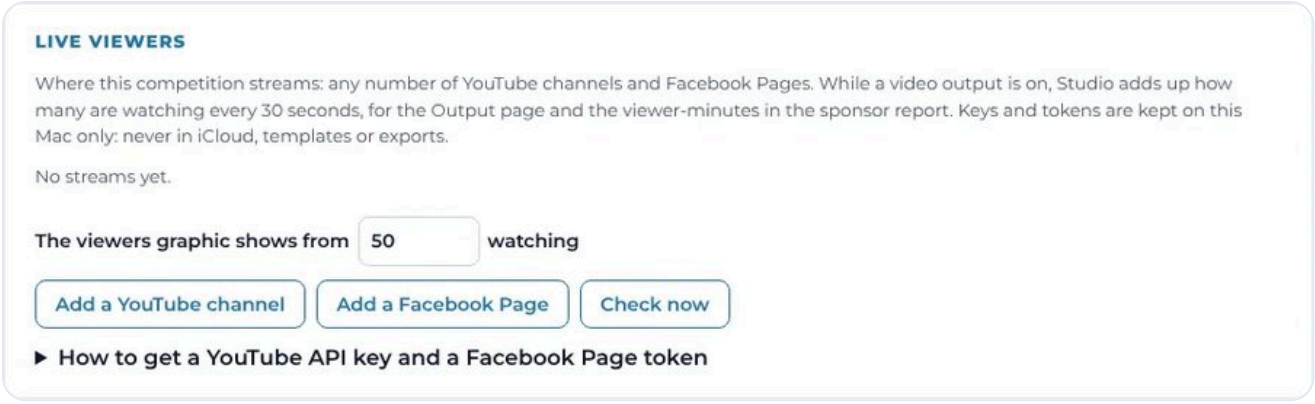
Competition logo, light and dark mode.



Team logos and the teams on PlayHQ, grouped by club with a club colour each.

Live viewers

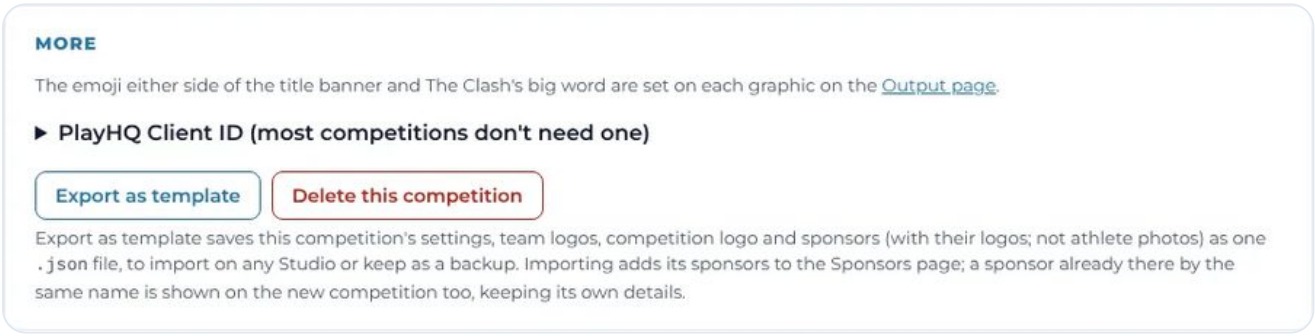
Add the YouTube channels and Facebook Pages the competition streams to. While a video output is on, Studio adds up how many are watching every 30 seconds, for the Output page, the viewers graphic (which shows only from the minimum set here) and the viewer-minutes in the sponsor report. The page explains how to get a YouTube API key and a Facebook Page token; both are kept on this Mac only, never in iCloud, templates or exports.



Live viewers.

Templates, export and more

Export as template saves the competition's settings, team logos, competition logo, font and sponsors (with their logos) as one .json file to import on any Studio or keep as a backup; **Import a template file** adds it. A PlayHQ Client ID is only needed if PlayHQ's game page has no line-ups and the association has given you one. **Delete this competition** removes it; deleting the one in use switches the graphics to another.



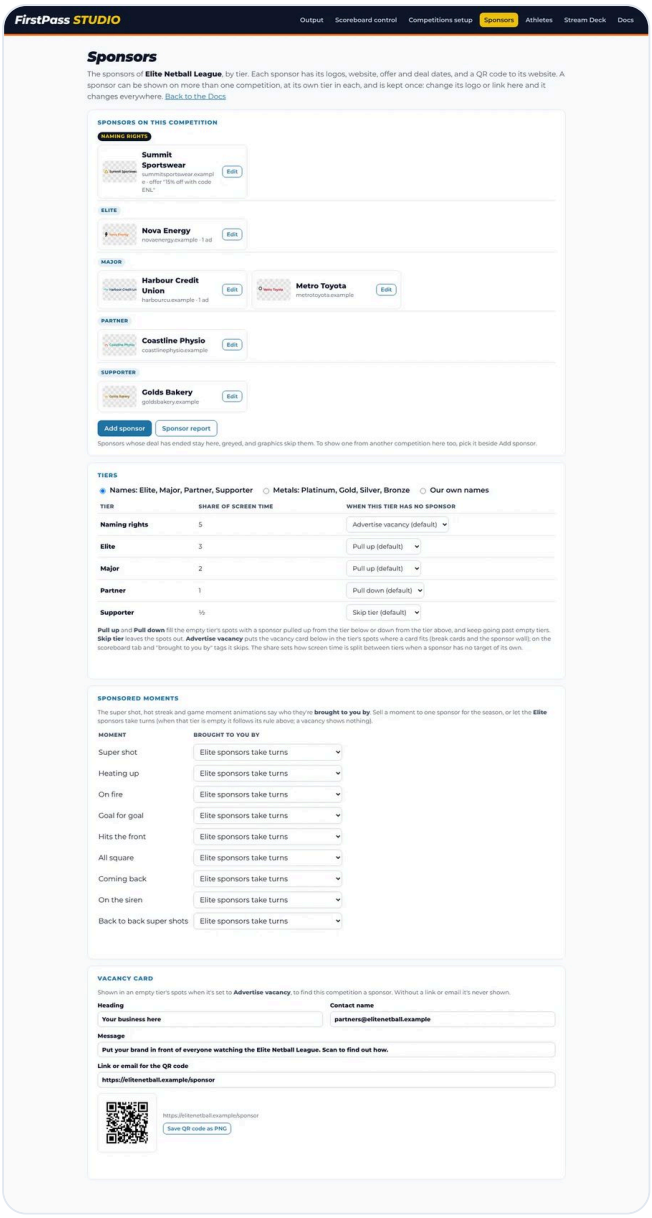
The More section: Client ID, export and delete.

Sponsors

The Sponsors tab turns sponsorship into something you can sell, run and prove: a tiered library of sponsors, spots on the graphics that fill themselves, ad breaks that take turns fairly, and a report of what each sponsor got.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Tiers
2 A sponsor
3 Spots and moments
4 Proof of play



The Sponsors page for the sample league: sponsors by tier with tonight's exposure meter, the tier rules, sponsored moments and the vacancy card.

Tiers

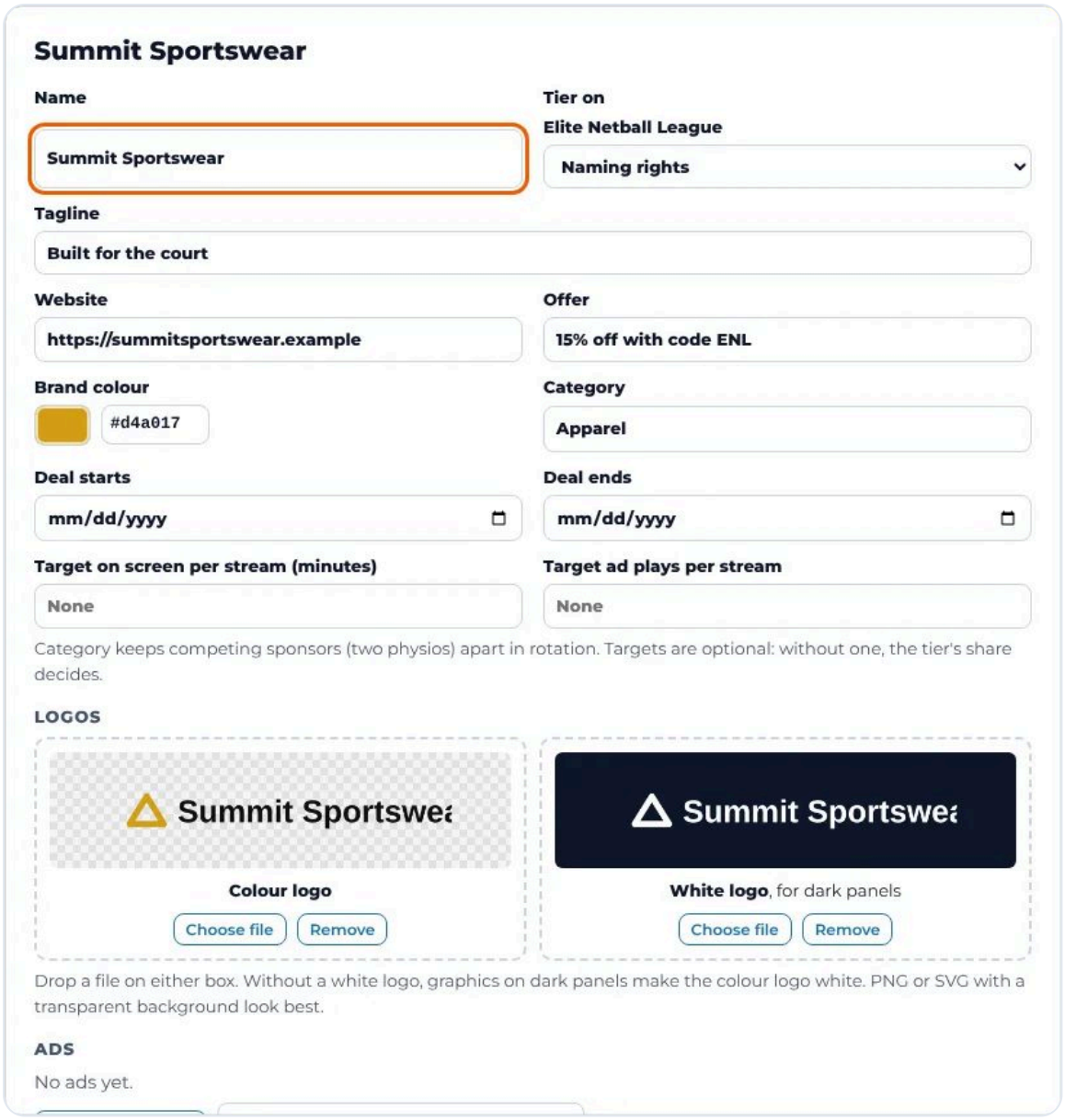
Five fixed ranks, named per competition: the **Names** preset (Naming rights, Elite, Major, Partner, Supporter), the **Metals** preset (Naming rights, Platinum, Gold, Silver, Bronze) or your own. Each tier's **share of screen time** decides how turns are split when a sponsor has no target of its own. Each tier gets different places:

TIER	WHERE IT SHOWS
Naming rights	A tab on the scoreboard, under the title banner, first on the sponsor wall, and everything below.
Elite	The sponsored moments (super shot, streaks), ads in the breaks, the break card, and everything below.
Major	Ads and break cards, "presented by" footers on the stats cards, countdown and top shooters.
Partner	A slot in the score ticker and the logo spots.
Supporter	The sponsor wall and the end-of-night strip.

When this tier has no sponsor says what a spot does when its tier is empty: **Pull up** fills it from the tier below, **Pull down** from the tier above, **Skip tier** leaves it out, and **Advertise vacancy** shows the competition's vacancy card wherever a card fits. The vacancy card has a heading, a contact, a message and a link or email for its QR code, so an empty tier finds its own sponsor.

A sponsor

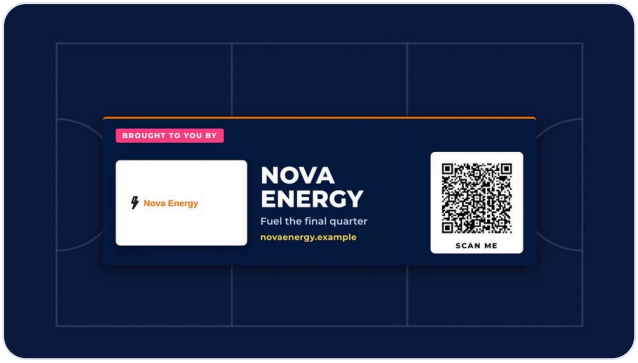
A sponsor has a name, tagline, website, offer, brand colour, category, deal dates, and optional targets per stream (minutes on screen, ad plays). Category keeps competing sponsors apart in rotation. Add a colour logo and a white one for dark panels (without a white one, the colour logo is made white). A sponsor is kept once and can be **shown on** several competitions at its own tier in each; sponsors whose deal has ended stay greyed and the graphics skip them.



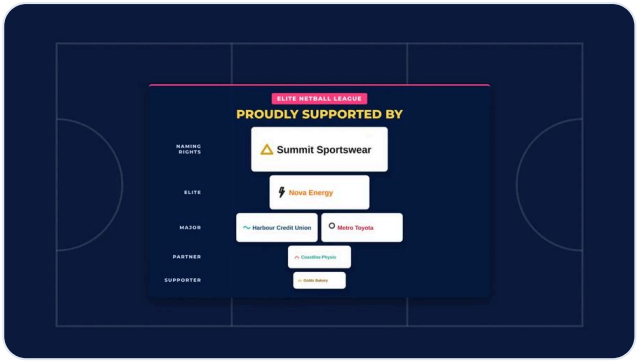
The sponsor editor: details, logos, ads, the QR code with tracking tags, and the competitions it is shown on.

Ads are videos or stills (up to 10 per sponsor) in the media folder. A **Sponsor ads** step in a sequence plays the next ads due, taking turns fairly by tier, each video to its end with sound and each still for its seconds; tick **House ad** and the PIVT and FirstPass Studio ad plays when nothing is due. The **QR code** points to the sponsor's website with tracking tags, so visits from the stream show in their analytics; save it as a PNG for the sponsor's own use.

Spots and moments



The sponsor card in a break, with its QR code.

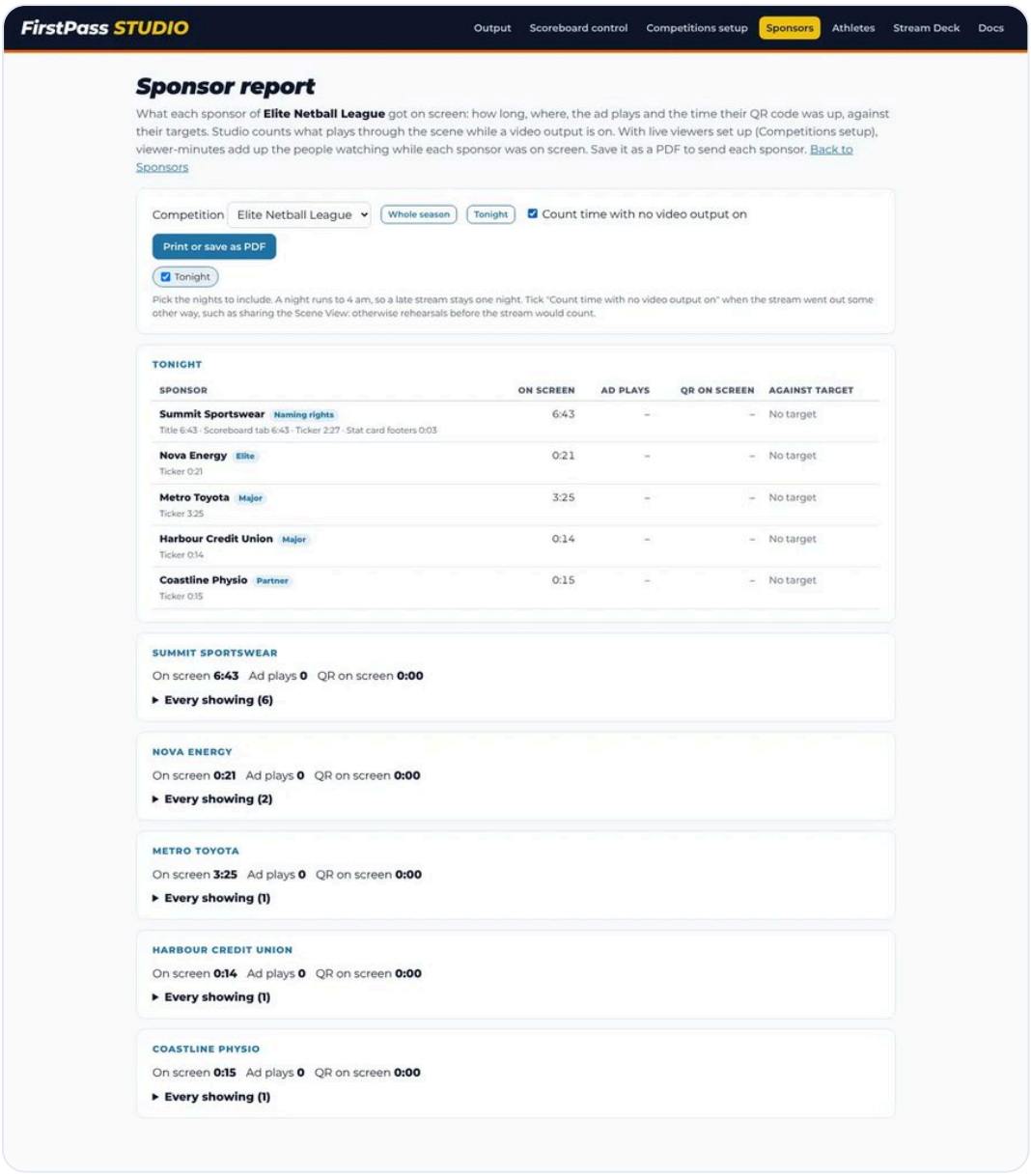


The sponsor wall before the game, sized by tier.

Every spot picks its sponsor from the Sponsors page by default. Each graphic's **Sponsor** option can pin one sponsor or turn the spot off. **Sponsored moments** sells the super shot, each hot streak and each game moment to one sponsor for the season, whose name appears in a "brought to you by" tag on the animation; by default the Elite sponsors take turns.

Proof of play

While a video output is on, Studio logs every second each sponsor is on screen and every ad played, matched to the scene's sources, and reads the live viewer count every 30 seconds. **Sponsor report** turns that into a page per night (or a run of nights) with minutes on screen, ad plays, viewer-minutes, peak and average viewers per sponsor, ready to print or save as a PDF for the sponsor. A tick box counts time with no video output on, for a rehearsal. With more than one output, only Output 1 and outputs with **Counts for sponsors** ticked are counted, and each counts as on air only while it's on: an output set to **Web links only** is off.



The sponsor report for the sample night.

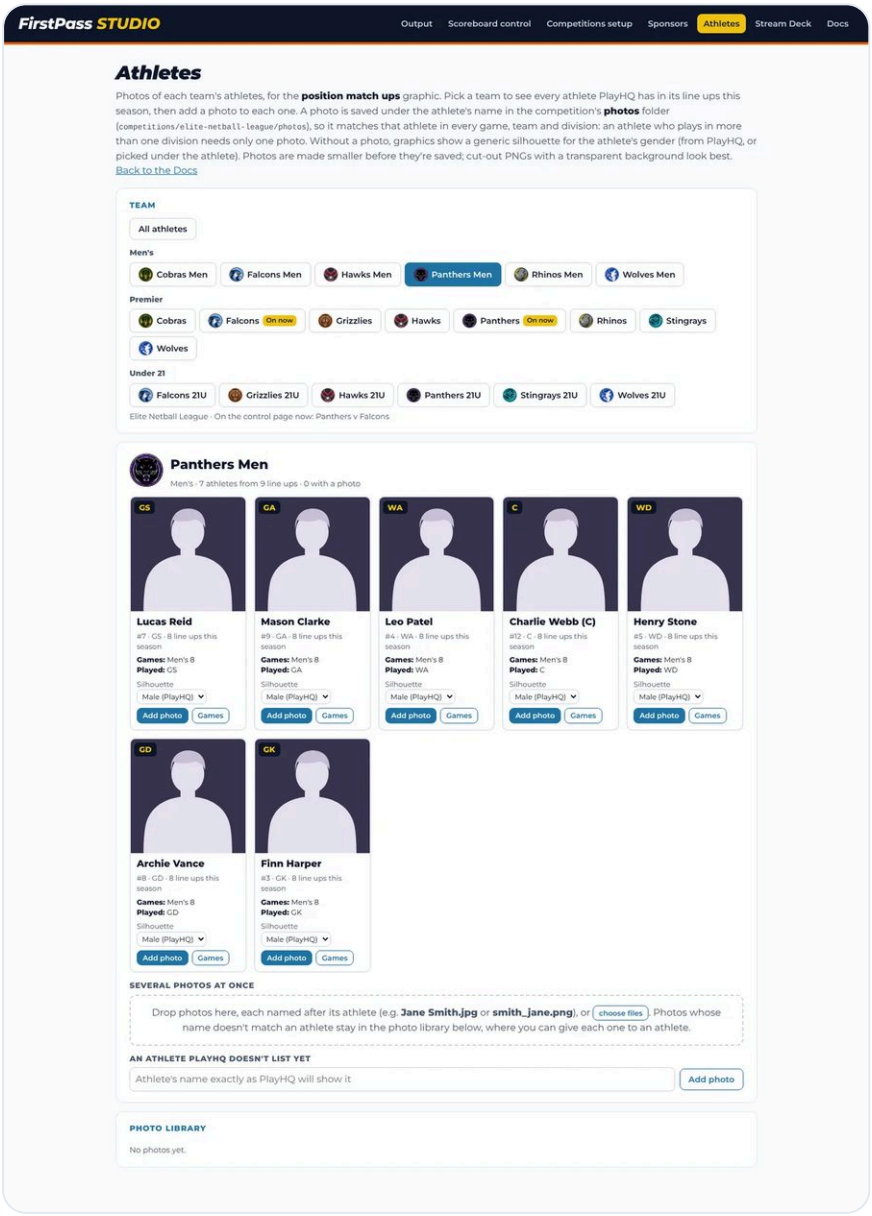
Athletes

PlayHQ gives Studio every athlete in a line-up, but not their faces. The Athletes tab holds a photo per athlete for the position match ups and the person lower third, and a record of positions and games played that PlayHQ's history doesn't cover.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Photos

2 Positions and games played

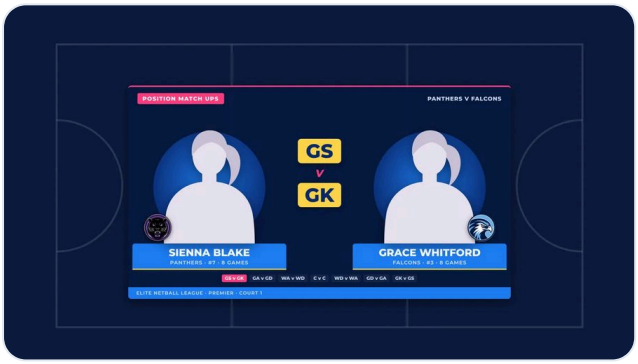


The Athletes page: teams grouped by division, every athlete PlayHQ has in a line-up this season, and the photo library.

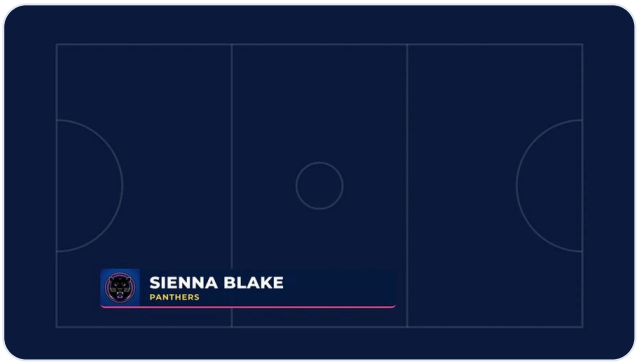
Photos

Pick a team and add a photo to each athlete, or drop a folder of photos named after the athletes ("Jane Smith.jpg" or "smith_jane.png") on **Several photos at once**; any that don't match wait in the photo library to be given to someone. A photo is saved under the athlete's name for the competition, so an athlete in two divisions needs one photo. Studio also remembers each athlete's PlayHQ id, so if PlayHQ changes a player's name during the season, their photo still finds them. Photos are made smaller when saved; cut-out PNGs with a transparent background look best. Without a photo the graphics show a silhouette for the athlete's gender, taken from the division (men's, women's; mixed and open are neutral) and changeable under the athlete. **An athlete PlayHQ doesn't list yet** adds one ahead of their first game.

A photo only goes on the stream and the Socials pictures once **Approved for photo use** is ticked under the athlete. Tick it when the athlete, or their parent or guardian, has agreed to their image being used. Until then the graphics show the silhouette. **Approve all for photo use** ticks every athlete listed for the team at once.



Position match ups use the photos, pairing by pairing.



The athlete lower third, named from the register as you type on the Output page.

Positions and games played

Games under an athlete opens their record. Positions played in a PlayHQ line-up this season are ticked already; tick any others from other seasons or competitions. Games played takes a line per division (and club): the number as of a date, to which Studio adds the games PlayHQ shows after it, so milestones keep up through the season. With no line, a division's games are this season's from PlayHQ.



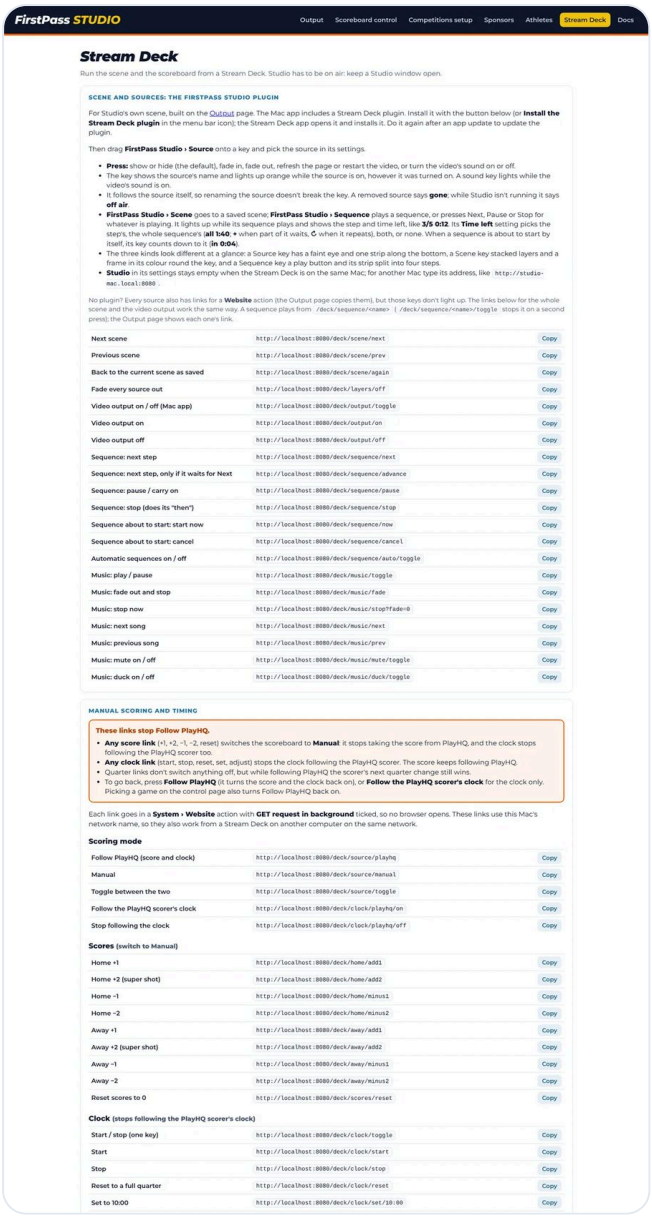
An athlete's positions and games played.

Stream Deck

A Stream Deck is the control surface for stream night: one key per source, scene and sequence, each lit while it's on, plus score, clock and quarter keys for a game run by hand. Studio ships its own plugin, and every control also has a plain link.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 The plugin
2 Links for everything else
3 Timed keys and the icon pack



The Stream Deck tab: the plugin, the scoring and clock links, and the full reference below them.

The plugin

Install it from the 1P menu (**Install the Stream Deck plugin**) or the button on the Output page; the Stream Deck app opens and installs it. Do the same after an app update. The **Studio** field in a key's settings stays empty when the Stream Deck is on the same Mac; for another Mac, type its address, like `http://studio-mac.local:8080` . Four kinds of key, each a different shape at a glance:

KEY	LOOKS	PRESS	SHOWS
Source	A faint eye and one strip along the bottom	Show or hide (default), fade in, fade out, refresh the page or restart the video, video sound on or off	The source's name; lit in its output's colour while it's on, however it was turned on
Scene	Stacked layers and a frame in its colour	Go to a scene, next or previous scene, or back to the current scene as saved	Lit while its scene is on, with a yellow dot when sources have changed since
Sequence	A play button and a strip in four steps	Play or stop a sequence, play from the first step, or Next, Next when waiting, Pause and Stop for whatever is playing	Step and time left, like **3/5 0:12**, the whole sequence's time, both or none; **in 0:04** when one is about to start by itself
Switcher	A camera and a strip in two halves	A camera to preview (default) or program, stinger to a camera, Cut, Auto, an upstream or downstream key, Fade to black, run a macro	The camera's name from the switcher; red on program and green on preview, a key or Fade to black red while on air; a yellow dot while the switcher isn't answering

Keys follow their source, scene or sequence by id, so renaming on the Output page doesn't break them; a removed one says **gone**, and while Studio is off air they say **off air**. Colour groups keys by the part of the stream: green pre-game, blue live, purple quarter time, grey post-game, yellow ads, or the scene's or sequence's own colour.

With more than one output, each key has an **Output** setting: the output it shows a source on, plays a scene on or plays a sequence on (a Switcher key has none: there is one switcher). A lit key takes its output's colour (Output 1 orange, 2 pink, 3 blue, 4 green) with a black title, so a commentators' Stream Deck of Commentary keys lights pink while the stream's keys light orange. A key for a removed output says **no output**.

Links for everything else

Every control is also a link, for a **System > Website** action (tick **GET request in background**), a Multi Action, or any program on the network. Scoreboard control, the Output page and the Stream Deck tab copy them, with this Mac's Stream Deck key

after the port (`…:8080/k/key/deck/…`) so no web page can press them. The Studio plugin needs no key: the first time you press one of its keys the Mac asks you to **Allow** it, and from then on it signs every press with its own key pair. A link without it is refused, so copy any older Website keys' links again from Studio. With more than one Stream Deck, give each its own link set: pick **New link set…** in **Copy links for** on the Stream Deck tab, name it after the Stream Deck, and copy its links from there. If a link gets out, choose **Devices…** in the menu bar icon and press **Make a new key** on that set: its links stop working and you copy them again, while the other Stream Decks carry on. A program on another computer can ask for a key of its own: the Mac asks you to **Allow** or **Deny** it by name and address, and Devices… can take that one away without touching your other keys. The useful ones:

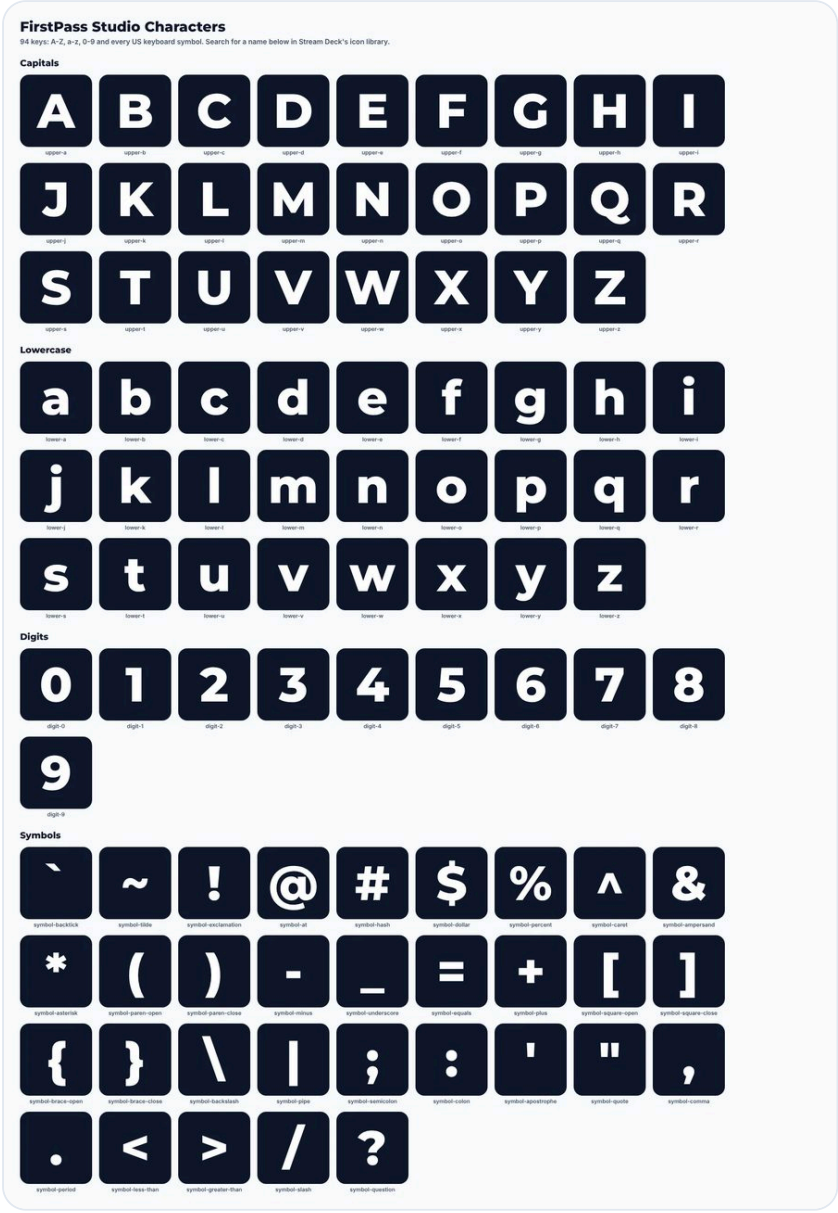
GROUP	LINKS
Scores	Home and away +1, +2, −1, −2; reset to 0; play a super shot or any streak without changing the score.
Scoring mode	Follow PlayHQ, Manual, toggle. Any score key switches to Manual.
Clock	Start, stop, toggle, reset, set to a time, add or take off any amount, follow the PlayHQ clock on or off, quarter length.
Quarter	Q1 to Q4, extra time, next, previous. The clock is separate; pair them in a Multi Action.
Game	Automatic selection on, off, toggle; the court to follow.
Ticker	Faster, slower, normal, a set speed.
Sources	Show, hide, toggle, restart, video sound; every source out; video output on or off.
Scenes	Go to a scene, next, previous, back to the scene as saved.
Sequences	Play, toggle, next, advance (only when waiting), pause, stop, start the one about to start now, cancel it, automatic sequences on or off.
Music	Play, pause, resume, stop, fade out, next, previous, load a song or playlist, mute, duck; add `?fade=2` for a 2-second fade.
Sponsors	Play the next sponsor ad due.
Switcher	Cut, auto, stinger (to a camera or what's on preview), fade to black, a camera to preview or program, an upstream or downstream key on, off or toggled, run a macro.

A LAYOUT THAT WORKS

Put the scene keys in a row across the top (Pre-game, Live game, Clear), the sequence keys under them with Next when waiting and Stop at the end, and a page of Source keys for the lower thirds and stats. A game run by hand gets a second page: home scores left, away scores right, the clock and quarter keys down the middle.

Timed keys and the icon pack

A second plugin, **Timed Sequence**, arms a key for a time of day and then presses a list of links with delays between them: reset the board at 18:55 and start the clock at 19:00, say. It is built from the repository. The **FirstPass Studio Characters** icon pack gives Stream Deck keys letters, numbers and symbols in the Studio style, for labelling keys by hand.



The Characters icon pack: A to Z, a to z, 0 to 9 and the usual symbols on navy.

CHAPTER 10 OF 11

Settings and care

Where Studio keeps its settings, how to carry them between Macs and back them up, how updates arrive, and what to do when something isn't right.

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 The 1P menu
2 The data folder
3 Settings in iCloud Drive
4 Backup and restore
5 Updates
6 Links and other devices
7 When something isn't right
8 Data and bandwidth

The 1P menu

The menu bar icon is Studio's home. From top to bottom: the version and whether Studio is on air; **Stop Studio** (while on air); **Open Studio**, Scoreboard control, Competition setup and **Copy the Studio link**; **Devices…**; **Install the Stream Deck plugin**; **Open the settings folder**, **Settings folder** (iCloud), **Back up…** and **Restore…**; **Open the debug log**, **Open the app log**, **Restart Studio**, **Check for updates**; **Open at login**, **Only this Mac can change things**, **What's new…** and Quit.

The data folder

Everything Studio saves lives in one folder outside the app, `~/Library/Application Support/FirstPass Studio`, so updates never touch it. In it: **competitions/** (a folder per competition with its settings, logos, font, athlete photos and register), **sponsors/**, the scene, sequences, music and playlists, the **media** folder, **control.json** (Scoreboard control's choices), **scoreboard-state.json** (the game, scores and clock, saved every few seconds so a restart mid-game loses nothing), **config.json** for this Mac's own settings, **logs/** and **backups/**.

Settings in iCloud Drive

Settings folder > Move to iCloud Drive… moves the settings into a folder you choose in iCloud Drive, in a subfolder named after this Mac, so each Mac on the same Apple account keeps its own and none saves over another's. The debug log, scores and clock, caches and window positions always stay on the Mac. **Restore from another Mac…**

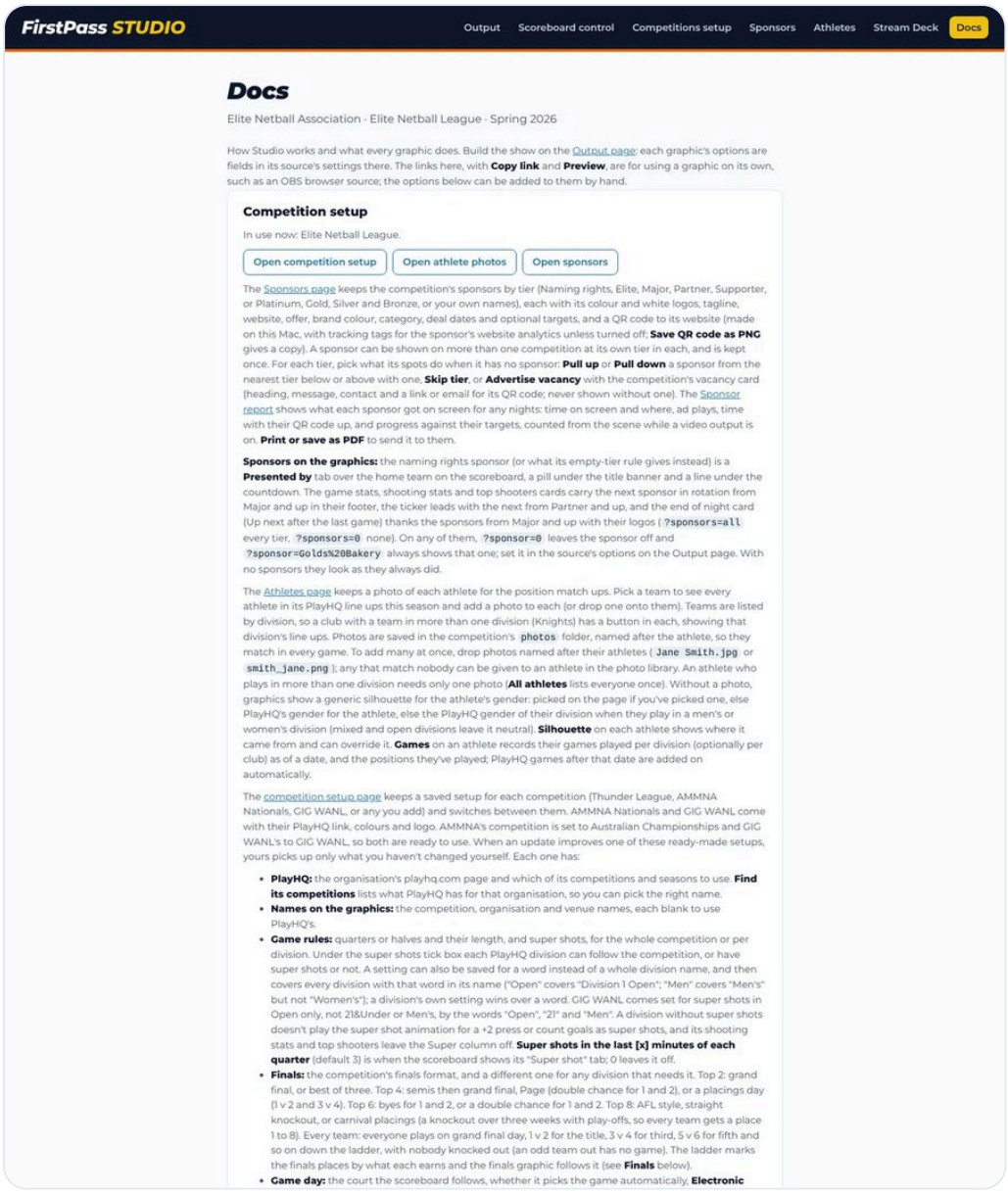
copies another Mac's settings over this one's (competitions, scenes, sequences, music, control choices), backing this Mac's up first. **Move back to this Mac…** undoes the move. Studio goes off air for a moment for each and comes straight back.

Backup and restore

Back up… saves every setting in one zip named with the date and time, with notes you type and, if you choose, the media folder; beside it goes a text summary listing the competitions, sequences, playlists, sources, scenes and sponsors inside. **Restore…** shows when and where a backup was made and what it holds, backs up this Mac's settings first, and replaces them only once the whole zip has unpacked and checked out. This Mac keeps its own **Only this Mac can change things** choice, port and link name whatever the backup says. Make a backup after setting up a season and before trying anything new on the Output page.

Updates

Updates download by themselves and install when the app quits, never mid-stream; **Check for updates** looks now, and **Restart to update** appears when one is ready. If a newer version has come out since that one downloaded, it asks whether to get the newer one first or install the one it named. The first launch after an update shows **What's new**, the changes since the version you last opened. When an update changes how settings are saved, Studio backs the data folder up to **backups/** first; settings saved by a newer Studio open read-only in an older one.



The Docs tab: every page with its link, Copy and Preview, the page options, and the notes this guide draws on.

Links and other devices

Studio's links use this Mac's Bonjour name (the Local hostname in System Settings > General > Sharing), so the same link works from a phone, another computer or a Stream Deck on the network; `localhost` still works on the Mac. Anything on the network can open the graphics. Only this Mac can change scores, the scene, sequences and settings: **Only this Mac can change things** is ticked every time Studio opens. To score from a phone or let another computer drive, pair it instead: open `/pair.html` on it (the Studio link with `/pair.html` on the end), type a name and press **Ask the Mac**, then choose **Allow scoring only** or **Allow everything** on the Mac. A paired device works with the box ticked, and **Devices...** in the menu bar icon lists it, changes what it may do, or removes it. Unticking the box lets every device on the network in until Studio quits; keep that for emergencies. On a network you don't control, leave it ticked, or block incoming connections to FirstPass Studio in the Mac's firewall.

When something isn't right

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The board doesn't move before the game	Normal: nothing is read before the electronic scoring window opens. Scoreboard control says when it will start checking.
The board stops mid-game	PlayHQ isn't answering. Switch to Manual and run it by hand; Follow PlayHQ picks it up again when PlayHQ is back.
The wrong night or game is on	Pick the game night on Scoreboard control and pick the game; tick automatic selection again afterwards.
A key says off air	No Studio window is open. Open Studio from the 1P menu.
A graphic looks stale	Press its Restart key or turn it off and on; with **Load the page fresh** on it reloads each time.
Studio itself stops	**Restart Studio** in the 1P menu brings it back with the scores and clock it had.
Anything else	**Open the debug log** in the 1P menu. Everything Studio does and every PlayHQ answer is in it, 15 MB at most. Send it with a note of the time.

Data and bandwidth

The graphics only ever talk to Studio on the Mac. Studio alone contacts PlayHQ: one small request every 5 seconds for the followed game (or as set, down to one a second), the ticker's other courts every 30 seconds, the fixture about once a minute for automatic selection, and the rest once when a graphic loads. The Production Planner and the Socials tab read the same fixture, results and ladders through the same cache, and finished games' line ups once, so they add nothing; the Fixture board reads other courts' live scores the ticker's way, so it adds nothing while the ticker is on and at most one request a minute per live game when it isn't. Commentator stats' auto-refresh asks Studio only; its team lists are read at the start and at each quarter break. Finished games are read once and kept. Extra outputs read the same data from Studio, so they add nothing here. It all comes to well under a megabyte an hour, so a phone hotspot is enough for Studio; the stream itself is the bandwidth.

Quick reference

IN THIS CHAPTER

1 Keyboard
2 Stream night in nine lines
3 Where things are set

Keyboard

WHERE	KEYS
Scoreboard control	A / Z home +1 / −1, K / M away +1 / −1, Shift for +2 / −2, Space starts or stops the clock.
Any Studio window	⌘1 to ⌘9 go to Output, Production Planner, Scoreboard control, Competitions setup, Sponsors, Athletes, Stream Deck, Socials, Docs. ⌘N new window, ⇧⌘O open in the browser, ⇧⌘C copy the page link, ⌘[back, ⌥⌘W close every Studio window.

Stream night in nine lines

1. Open Studio from the 1P menu and keep the Output page open all night.
2. Check the competition in use and the court on Competitions setup.
3. On Scoreboard control, the first game on your court is picked with Follow PlayHQ on.
4. Turn on the video output your switcher takes and show one graphic to see it land.
5. Play a few seconds of music and an animation with sound.
6. Press a Source key and watch the Output page follow it; put scoring back to Follow PlayHQ after testing.
7. Go to the Live game scene and let the sequences run the breaks.
8. Pick finals winners as they happen; turn on lower thirds when people appear.

9 Press Stream close, turn the output off, and send the sponsor report.

Where things are set

TO CHANGE	GO TO
Colours, font, logos, rules, finals format, court	Competitions setup
Which game, scoring mode, score, clock, finals winners	Scoreboard control
What's on screen, scenes, sequences, playlists, music, mics, outputs	Output
A graphic's options (heading, position, division, animate away)	Output, under the source's address
Sponsors, tiers, ads, moments, the report	Sponsors
Photos, positions, games played	Athletes
Each night's court, the commentators and who calls each game	Production Planner
Keys and links	Stream Deck
Pictures of a game night for social media	Socials
Backups, iCloud, updates, the debug log	The 1P menu

FirstPass Studio is made by PIVT. The Elite Netball League, its clubs, athletes and sponsors are fictional.